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Space Exploration Technologies Corp.

SPCX

EQUITY RESEARCH · 2026-08-12 · INDUSTRIALS · AEROSPACE & DEFENSE

RATING

Sell

FAIR VALUE \$38.13 · 12-MONTH

PRICE	MARKET CAP	FWD P/E	TARGET (MEAN)	NEXT EARNINGS
\$133.29	\$1.76T	71.9x	\$235.69 ▲ 76.8%	03 Nov

CONTENTS	
Investment Verdict	4. Supply Chain Positioning
Stock Chart	5. Financial Strength
Technical Analysis Summary	6. Valuation
Peer Comparison	7. Risks
1. Company Profile	Conclusion & Investment Thesis
2. Business Model	References
3. Competitive Landscape	Sources and Methodology

Investment Verdict

Rating	Sell MEDIUM CONVICTION
Fair value	\$38.13 (12-month)
Implied return	-71.39%
Vs. consensus	below
Method	Ten-year DCF at a 12% WACC, cross-checked against a 2028 EV/ EBITDA scenario frame (\$125.94 probability-weighted, which the DCF overrides) and Morningstar's ~\$40 launch-plus-Starlink value

Base case probability	50%
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THESIS

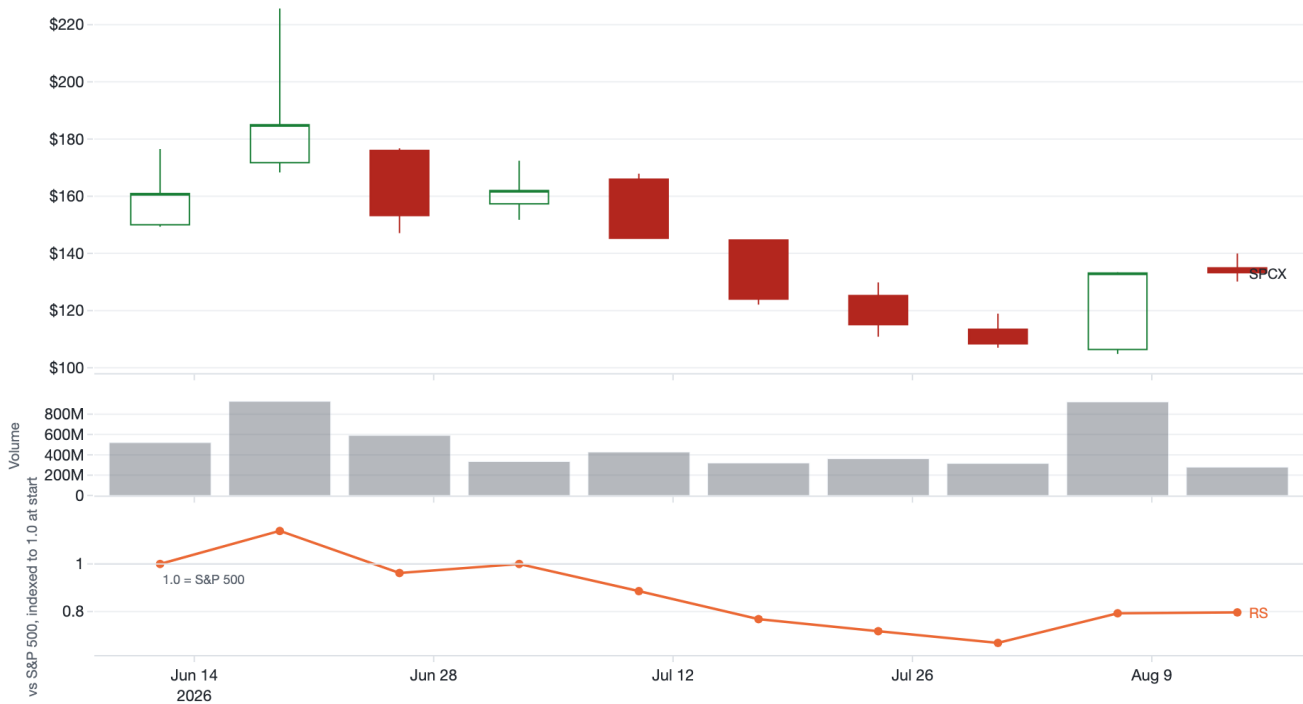
SpaceX trades at 30x 2028 adjusted EBITDA that excludes depreciation on assets rebought every five years, while consolidated ROIC is negative 6.3% against a 12% hurdle.

KEY RISK

The bull case is live: 10 gigawatts of compute by end-2027 with AI contracts running to term supports \$271.20 per share on our own scenario frame.

Rating, fair value and probabilities are the report writer's own assumptions, not company guidance or sell-side consensus. See the Conclusion for the reasoning and the tests that would falsify it.

Stock Chart



4-year weekly price with 13- and 52-week moving averages, volume, and relative strength vs the S&P 500

Technical Analysis Summary

INDICATOR	VALUE	SIGNAL
20-Day SMA	\$120.68	BULLISH
50-Day SMA	N/A	BEARISH
200-Day SMA	N/A	NO DATA
RSI (14)	52.3	NEUTRAL
MACD	-7.0	BULLISH
ATR (14)	\$11.25	VOLATILITY
Avg volume (20d)	103,815,620	LIQUIDITY

Trend status

- Long-term trend: NO DATA — insufficient trading history for a 200-day SMA
- Golden / death cross: NO DATA — requires a 200-day SMA

Peer Comparison

SYMBOL	NAME	PRICE	MARKET CAP	FWD P/E	REVENUE TTM	OP. MARGIN	REV. GRO WTH
SPCX	Space Exploration Technol...	\$133.29	\$1.76T	71.9	\$23.0B	-1.8%	91.9%
BA	The Boeing	\$233.24	\$184.3B	56.6	\$94.0B	0.0%	8.0%
LMT	Lockheed Martin	\$597.77	\$138.0B	18.3	\$77.0B	12.0%	10.5%
RTX	RTX	\$223.86	\$301.7B	28.5	\$93.5B	12.7%	14.5%
NOC	Northrop Grumman	\$575.69	\$81.8B	18.9	\$42.9B	11.6%	5.1%
GD	General Dynamics	\$391.89	\$106.0B	21.1	\$54.9B	10.4%	8.1%

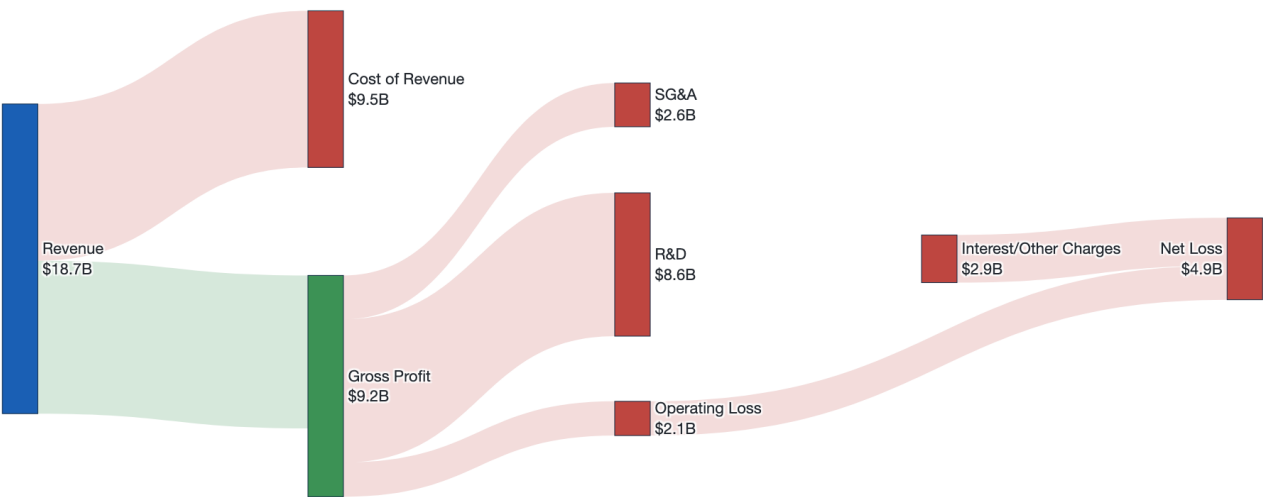
Forward P/E · revenue TTM · operating margin · year-over-year revenue growth, each from the named company's own reported figures. Subject shaded; a comparable with no fetched fundamentals reads N/A.

Sell-side price targets

MEASURE	TARGET	IMPLIED VS. \$133.29
Low	\$62.00	-53.5%
Mean	\$235.69	76.8%
Median	\$210.00	57.6%
High	\$800.00	500.2%

Sell-side consensus, not the report writer's own fair value. See the Investment Verdict for that.

Income Statement Flow



Revenue flowing through cost of revenue, operating expense and tax to net income

1. Company Profile

Space Exploration Technologies Corp. (NASDAQ: SPCX)¹ sells satellite broadband, rented AI compute and launch services, in that order of size. Revenue in the quarter ended June 30, 2026 was \$7.8 billion, up 91.9% year over year, split 54.9% Connectivity (Starlink), 32.8% AI and 12.3% Space; the fiscal year ends December 31.² It employs 21,000 people and carried a \$1.76 trillion market capitalization on August 12, 2026, per Yahoo Finance data.³ Starlink funds an AI infrastructure build the other segments could not pay for, and over 40% of the quarter's revenue growth came from cloud contracts a counterparty can cancel on 90 days' notice.² Elon Musk directs both, holding 82.4% of the vote on \$54,080 of 2025 cash pay.⁴⁵

History and Key Milestones

Elon Musk founded the company in 2002 and remains chief executive and chief engineer; it is incorporated in Texas and headquartered at 1 Rocket Road, Starbase.¹⁶³

Reusability came first, taking launch cost to roughly \$2,700 per kilogram against a historical industry average near \$18,500, on a published reading of the IPO prospectus.⁷ Of 37 Falcon launches in the second quarter of 2026, 27 were internal, and no inter-segment revenue is recognized on those flights, so reported Space revenue understates the launch franchise.²

Second, the company left Delaware. It reincorporated in Texas in February 2024, weeks after a Delaware court voided Musk's 2018 Tesla award.⁴ A Texas shareholder now needs 3% of the stock to bring a claim, in a business court sitting without a jury.⁴

Third, SpaceX absorbed X.AI Holdings Corp. on February 2, 2026 in what the filing labels "Common Control Mergers," and the comparatives now carry AI segment revenue back through the first half of 2025.² Pre-2026 SpaceX financial history in circulation is therefore not comparable with the reported series.

Fourth, it listed. Shares priced at \$135.00 on June 11, 2026 and first traded June 12.⁸⁹ The offering closed June 15 on 638,888,888 shares for \$85,675 million net of costs, the largest IPO on record.⁶²¹⁰

Core Business and Investment Highlights

Connectivity is the asset that matters and the only one that funds itself. Segment revenue grew 65.8% to \$4,291 million on subscriber growth of 101.2% to 12.0 million, served by more than 10,200 satellites across 167 markets.² We treat that subscriber growth as durable and the pricing behind it as unproven; Section 2 carries the unit economics.

AI is two businesses inside one segment, and only one of them grows. Segment revenue rose 247.5% to \$2,561 million, but advertising fell to \$367 million from \$426 million while AI solutions and infrastructure went from \$311 million to \$2,194 million.² AI supplied \$1,824 million of the

\$3,743 million consolidated revenue increase, and new cloud services agreements supplied \$1,600 million of that.² Space grew 29.0% to \$962 million in the quarter yet fell 1.9% to \$1,581 million in the half.² The launch business most investors think they are buying is the smallest and the slowest of the three.

Google's right to terminate on 90 days' notice opens after December 31, 2026, on the contract terms Section 2 sets out.²¹¹ Against that revenue sits the 2027 commitment ladder Section 4 sets out. We weight the bear side, because the commitments are contractual and the revenue is not.

Control and Incentive Structure

Musk's 2025 salary was \$54,080, against an economic claim on 42% to 46% of SpaceX's equity.⁵¹² The board granted him 1.3 billion performance-restricted Class B shares in January and March 2026. One billion of them require 15 market-capitalization milestones up to \$7.5 trillion plus a permanent human colony on Mars of at least 1 million inhabitants. The other 302 million require 12 milestones from \$1 trillion to \$6.6 trillion plus data centers delivering 100 terawatts of compute a year. Neither award carries a deadline beyond continued employment, and both legs of each are conjunctive, so a market-capitalization milestone vests nothing on its own.⁴ SpaceX calls the operational milestones "improbable," which is why no compensation expense runs through the income statement while that holds.⁴

The award exhibits give Musk the right to vote the restricted shares from the date of grant.⁴ At ten votes each, 1.3 billion restricted shares carry about 13,000 million of the 63,297 million votes outstanding, or 20.5% of the company's vote, conferred by stock that has vested on nothing (our arithmetic from the filed share counts).²⁴ Tesla built the same instrument the other way. Its 2025 award's 423,743,904 restricted shares sit under a voting agreement and an irrevocable proxy to Tesla's secretary, and they vote proportionately to all other shares. Tesla states that Musk "does not have dispositive or voting control over these shares."¹³ He accepted that proxy at Tesla and did not at SPCX, so outside holders here have no equivalent check.

The charter makes the control permanent rather than contingent. Class B carries ten votes to Class A's one,² the Class B block elects 51% of the board for as long as any Class B stock exists, and Musk holds 82.4% of the vote after the offering.⁴ He can be removed as chairman, chief executive and chief technology officer only by a vote of Class B holders, which gives him a veto over his own removal.¹⁴ Class B converts to Class A on transfer, so the control decays only if he sells.² A separate Class B class vote over combinations is also reported from the prospectus, which is not in our evidence base, so we do not rely on it.

No SPCX-Tesla merger has been announced, agreed or filed as of August 12, 2026.²¹⁵ Were one negotiated, SPCX absorbing Tesla's \$1.314 trillion of market value, as of August 11, 2026, for Class A stock at no premium would issue roughly 9,900 million one-vote shares. That would take Musk from 82.4% to about 71% of the vote, while a one-share-one-vote survivor would leave him near a third (our arithmetic, as of August 12, 2026).¹⁶¹³¹⁷ Any deal he supports will therefore be structured with SPCX as acquirer, or with the dual class carried into the parent. It

would not pay his SPCX awards, because the conjunctive legs above mean added market capitalization vests nothing without Mars or 100 terawatts.⁴¹⁸ What a change of control does to the 2026 grants is disclosed nowhere in our evidence base. The prospectus language on the subject predates both grants, and the June 8-Ks and the second-quarter filing are silent.²⁶

Recent Developments

SpaceX priced \$25.0 billion of senior unsecured notes on June 23, 2026 and repaid its bridge loan in full.¹⁹²⁰² The offering was announced on June 22, seven days after the \$86 billion equity sale closed, and the stock fell 16.4% that session, its worst as a public company (Section 7).¹⁹¹⁷ On June 16 it agreed an all-stock merger with Cursor, the corporate action Section 2 sizes, expected to close in the third quarter of 2026; the share count is struck on a pre-closing VWAP, so the dilution is not yet fixed.²¹²

2. Business Model

Revenue Mix & Segments

Connectivity produced \$1,656 million of segment operating income in the second quarter of 2026, while Space lost \$542 million and AI lost \$1,257 million.² The only segment earning an operating profit is not the one supplying the growth.

SEGMENT (\$M)	Q2 2026	% TOTAL	Y/Y	H1 Y/Y
Space	962	12.3%	+29.0%	(1.9)%
Connectivity	4,291	54.9%	+65.8%	+49.1%
AI	2,561	32.8%	+247.5%	+130.6%
Total	7,814	100%	+91.9%	+53.7%

Within Connectivity, consumer revenue was \$2,485 million and enterprise and government \$1,806 million. Within AI, advertising of \$367 million fell 13.8% year over year and is the only shrinking line in the company.²

Durability varies far more across that revenue base than the segment labels imply. Launch services are recognized at launch on fixed-price contracts, and launch and development work cost-to-cost over government programs running up to fourteen years. Consumer broadband is generally month-to-month. AI cloud is a fixed monthly fee for a stand-ready promise of reserved capacity, terminable by either party on 90 days' notice after an initial ramp.² Anthropic pays \$1.25 billion a month through May 2029 and either side may terminate on 90 days' notice, with no start date disclosed for that right.²² Google pays \$920 million a month from October 2026

through June 2029 for roughly 110,000 GPUs, and either party may terminate on 90 days' notice after December 31, 2026.¹¹ The fastest-growing revenue carries the shortest contractual life, and two unnamed customers were more than a third of the quarter (Section 4).

Addressable market is not the constraint. The S-1 published May 20, 2026 puts it at \$28.5 trillion, of which \$22.7 trillion, or 79.6%, is an enterprise-applications slice.⁹ The 10-Q's revenue disaggregation contains no such category, so we discard it.² Against the remaining \$5.8 trillion, annualized second-quarter revenue is 0.54% (our estimate, as of June 30, 2026).

Monetization & Margin Dynamics

Gross margin is expanding in all three segments, and the largest expansion is partly an allocation choice.

GROSS MARGIN / OPERATING MARGIN	Q2 2025	Q1 2026	Q2 2026
Space	55.8% / (49.5)%	54.6% / (106.9)%	65.8% / (56.3)%
Connectivity	45.9% / 35.7%	49.3% / 36.5%	52.0% / 38.6%
AI	25.2% / (206.8)%	44.3% / (301.8)%	56.8% / (49.1)%

Gross margin above is segment revenue less segment cost of revenue. Only three quarterly periods of segment data exist, because SpaceX has filed one 10-Q and one earnings release since listing.²²³

We discount AI's 31.6-point gross margin gain. The 10-Q attributes \$470 million of the segment's \$555 million cost-of-revenue increase to "more compute costs being allocated to cost of revenue as our AI infrastructure revenue increased," while AI research spending rose to \$2,178 million on the same driver.² One compute pool is split between two lines by declared use, and no outsider can audit the split. We weight segment adjusted EBITDA instead, at \$1,146 million against negative \$276 million a year earlier, earned because \$1.6 billion of incremental cloud revenue landed on largely sunk Colossus capacity.²³ Depreciation of \$1,885 million, 73.6% of AI revenue, keeps the segment loss-making.²

Connectivity is the only segment where operating leverage shows up in the trend, and it was partly purchased. Segment depreciation fell to 18.8% of segment revenue from 22.0% even as absolute depreciation rose, but ARPU fell 22.4% year over year to \$66 a month, unchanged from the first quarter, while subscribers doubled to 12.0 million, on international expansion and lower-priced plans.²¹⁵ Gross margin rose 6.1 points and operating margin only 2.9, because SG&A reached \$281 million and research spending \$294 million.

Space converts the best gross margin in the company into the worst operating margin, because Starship research spending of \$1,076 million exceeded the segment's entire revenue; that spending is discretionary, so the reported margin understates the segment's economics.² One

quarter of public reporting against recast comparatives shows no seasonal pattern. No bronze source gives a peer's segment gross margin, so Section 3's peer comparison stops at the operating line.

Competitive Advantages

Internal launch capture is the strongest advantage and the least visible in the P&L. Of the 1,041 metric tons SpaceX lifted in the first half of 2026, 908, or 87.2%, were its own payloads, and no inter-segment revenue is recognized on them; those launch costs are capitalized into satellites within property, plant and equipment.² Connectivity therefore builds its constellation at internal cost while every competitor buys launch at market price (Section 3). A rival reaching comparable cost per kilogram at comparable cadence would remove the advantage.

Enterprise switching costs are the second. Since 2023 no Starlink enterprise customer paying more than \$750,000 a year has voluntarily canceled, with United Airlines, Carnival, Maersk and John Deere named, and the same account reports enterprise gross margins above consumer.²⁴ Switching means re-installing and re-certifying terminals across vessels and airframes, which is why those contracts hold without term commitments. A first disclosed enterprise loss would falsify the claim.

AI has no advantage we can evidence. SpaceX accounts for the offering as a stand-ready promise to provide access to reserved compute capacity, sold on 90-day mutual termination, and management called the company "exclusive to NVIDIA" on the August 4, 2026 call.²¹⁵ The two defensible franchises are 67.2% of revenue, and the undefended one absorbs most of the capital.

Growth Drivers & Capital Allocation

Capital allocation has chosen the segment with the shortest contracts and the weakest defenses. AI took the great majority of both second-quarter and first-half capital expenditure (Sections 4 and 5), against operating cash flow that covered a small fraction of it. There is no dividend and no repurchase program (Section 5). Connectivity supplies the one fully evidenced organic vector, with enterprise and government revenue up 108.3% year over year.²

The CFO guided to "\$100 billion of ARR or annualized revenue run rate by the end of this year based on our expected revenue in the month of December," including a contribution from Cursor [GUIDANCE, Q2 2026 call, August 4, 2026], against annualized second-quarter revenue of \$31.3 billion and trailing twelve-month revenue of \$23.0 billion.¹⁵²²⁵ Reaching it requires December revenue of roughly \$8.3 billion in a single month, against \$2.6 billion a month in the second quarter (our estimate, as of August 12, 2026). The one contracted step toward it is disclosed: \$6.7 billion of additional cloud services revenue signed in the first weeks of the third quarter over a six-month period that begins ramping in October 2026, or about \$1.1 billion a month at full ramp [GUIDANCE, same call].¹⁵ That is 31% more per quarter than the AI segment's entire second quarter, and the company disclosed no termination terms for it.

Corporate actions changed the reported mix more than the economics. The xAI merger completed February 2, 2026 was a common-control transaction: no consideration was recorded, and fiscal 2023 through 2025 were recast as though xAI and X had always been part of the company, so the AI segment's multi-year growth is partly definitional.² Cursor is to be acquired for Class A stock at an implied equity value of \$60.0 billion,²¹ and the 10-Q expects that merger to close in the third quarter of 2026 subject to regulatory approvals.² The EchoStar spectrum purchase, an all-stock equity leg plus a debt payoff that Section 6 prices, has not reached its second-step closing.² No spin-off, carve-out or divestiture has been announced, so none of the margin improvement above comes from shedding a low-margin business.

Spacecraft cost per watt, not launch price, decides whether orbital compute closes. In the published orbital cost model that comes closest to parity, launch is about \$5 billion of a \$41 billion five-year gigawatt, roughly 12%, while satellite hardware and its periodic replacement are about 87%. At today's roughly \$22 per watt of satellite hardware there is no parity at any launch price, including zero, and the threshold requires \$5 to \$10 per watt.²⁶ SpaceX's FCC narrative assumes 100 watts per kilogram, and AI1's published specification 70 watts per kilogram, a band of 10 to 14.3 kg/kW.²⁷²⁶ Set against Epoch AI's \$8,500 per kilowatt-year terrestrial cost of ownership, with chips priced the same in both venues, a five-year life on each side and satellite hardware already at the \$5 to \$10 per watt threshold, parity comes at roughly \$390 to \$1,050 per kilogram to low earth orbit, and \$390 to \$735 at AI1's own 14.3 kg/kW (our estimate, as of August 12, 2026).²⁸ Investment-bank projections of the Falcon-to-Starship transition run from about \$2,700 per kilogram toward \$100 (third-party estimate, as of August 10, 2026).²⁹ That projected path passes through the \$390 to \$1,050 parity band well before it reaches \$100, so lift cost is not the binding constraint. The \$22 per watt of satellite hardware is, and it has to fall by half to three-quarters.

SpaceX's filings and its executive incentives point in opposite directions, and we underwrite the filings. The 10-Q and the 8-Ks in our evidence carry no orbital-compute capital expenditure, no segment line and no risk factor.²³⁰²¹ Against that silence, SpaceX filed an FCC application on January 30, 2026 for the "SpaceX Orbital Data Center system," seeking authority for up to one million satellites.³¹ The March 2026 AI CEO Award of 302 million shares vests across twelve market-cap tranches only alongside "the Company's completion of non-Earth-based data centers capable of delivering 100 terawatts of compute per year."⁷²⁴ A single orbital gigawatt at the central mass assumption needs roughly 14,300 metric tons of upmass (our estimate, as of August 12, 2026), about fourteen times everything SpaceX flew in the first half of 2026, internal payloads included.²⁶ We expect no material orbital-compute revenue before 2029 and treat the program as option value, which Section 6 prices.

Risks to the Model

The model assumes AI compute customers keep paying past the 90-day notice window. Contracted sales, SpaceX's term for the non-cancellable, enforceable period only, were \$14.1 billion against roughly \$70 to \$75 billion of nominal value in the two agreements above, or about 19% (our estimate, as of August 12, 2026).²³²²¹¹ Backlog of \$47,461 million excludes

month-to-month subscribers entirely, so it overstates AI visibility and understates the most durable revenue in the company.² Two further tensions carry the case: Starlink net additions must keep outrunning the ARPU decline, and orbital compute needs a spacecraft cost per watt that nobody has disclosed.

3. Competitive Landscape

SpaceX is gaining share where share can be measured, which is launch: BryceTech counted 51% of 2025 orbital launches and 85% of satellites³². In satellite broadband and AI compute we can evidence subscriber and capacity growth only. The first-half fall in launch cadence is not evidence against the launch position. Falcon flew 77 times in the first half of 2026 against 81 a year earlier, customer launches fell from 21 to 17, and internal Starlink launches held at 60, so customer flights absorbed the entire decline². Neither US alternative could take them: the Space Force paused national-security Vulcan flights after a nozzle burn-through on the otherwise successful February 12 USSF-87 mission^{33 34}, and New Glenn has not flown since a May 28 static-fire explosion destroyed the vehicle and damaged Blue Origin's only pad³⁵. We read the shortfall as SpaceX prioritizing its own deployment, not as displacement. A Starship-transition reading fails on the filing's one Starship flight in the half against three a year earlier. Management called the quarter SpaceX's "highest Falcon cadence"¹⁵ against 37 Falcon launches in Q2 versus 45, so we use the filing². Customer launches falling again in the second half, with both rivals flying, would change our reading.

Launch

Launch share is structural and pricing power is intact. The BryceTech shares above are computed from 165 of 325 global orbital launches in 2025. SpaceX then raised Falcon 9 pricing from \$70 million to \$74 million in February 2026³⁶, and AST SpaceMobile, a Connectivity rival, paid it in August³⁷. It stayed the low bid on national-security work: fiscal 2027 task orders gave SpaceX five missions for \$714 million and ULA two for \$428 million, about \$143 million against \$214 million each [ESTIMATE, from those totals]³⁸. In payloads, SpaceX has won \$6.45 billion of Golden Dome awards, more than all other contractors combined³⁹.

ULA is the only direct rival with comparable government scale, at \$5.3 billion and 19 NSSL Phase 3 Lane 2 missions to SpaceX's \$5.9 billion and 28⁴⁰; Blue Origin holds seven of the 54 missions and has flown New Glenn three times⁴¹. Vulcan's grounding has strained ULA's balance sheet: Lockheed guaranteed ULA borrowings with maximum potential payments of \$500 million in Q2 2026⁴². Rocket Lab is the closest analogue, at Q2 2026 revenue of \$234 million, up 62%, on \$2.36 billion of backlog⁴³, but Neutron has not flown and its \$8.0 billion Iridium deal closes only in mid-2027⁴⁴. SpaceX keeps both out by pricing below them on government work while raising list price. The pool grows from \$11.82 billion in 2025 to \$24.42 billion in 2030 [ESTIMATE, Research and Markets]⁴⁵, but at 2% of the \$626 billion space economy it cannot carry the case⁴⁶.

Connectivity

Share here comes from exiting incumbents. Starlink ended Q2 2026 with 12.0 million subscribers against 6.0 million a year earlier ². HughesNet's parent filed Chapter 11 and told the court that "LEO satellite competition is structural, not cyclical", while Viasat's US residential base fell from 603,000 to 115,000 "primarily due to Starlink" ⁴⁷.

Amazon is the threat that matters. Amazon Leo has 375+ satellites across 14 missions but no commercial service and no published subscribers ⁴⁸, and targets a terminal under \$400 against Starlink's \$499 dish ⁴⁹. New Glenn's grounding caps deployment, so Amazon competes on distribution instead. Delta chose Amazon Leo for 500 aircraft from 2028 on its AWS relationship, against SpaceX contracts covering more than 7,000 aircraft and 11 airline signings in 2026 after 22 in 2025 ⁵⁰. Amazon is also buying Globalstar for \$11.57 billion, with Apple's satellite relationship attached ⁵¹.

Amazon has not yet forced a price war. Blended ARPU held flat sequentially (Section 2) ¹⁵, and segment operating margin rose to 38.6% from 35.7% ². The 2026 US promotions are address-gated to "select regions, typically those where Starlink has excess capacity" ⁵², which is yield management on a fixed-capacity asset. First-half margin of 37.7% against 38.6% is the counterweight, so the expansion remains a single-quarter fact ².

AI compute

SpaceX has bought revenue scale here without a comparable contract book. The AI segment did \$2,561 million of Q2 2026 revenue, within \$14 million of CoreWeave's \$2,575 million ⁵³, but CoreWeave carries about \$104 billion of backlog against SpaceX's \$47.5 billion across all three segments ². That backlog is softer than the headline: CoreWeave includes in it amounts it estimates will be recognized "subject to the satisfaction of delivery and availability of service requirements", and it rests on 3.7 GW of contracted power against 1.5 GW active ⁵³.

Two of the largest customers are also competitors. Google rents roughly 110,000 GPUs on the monthly terms and termination rights set out in Section 2, and Anthropic buys compute on its own cancellable agreement ¹¹. Google is also building Project Suncatcher, an orbital-compute program aimed at SpaceX's own target market ⁵⁴. Every AI cloud vendor is growing because supply binds, so we treat this share as contractual until a renewal proves otherwise.

Peer benchmark

COMPANY	SEGMENT	Q2'26 REVENUE	Y/Y	MARGIN
SPCX	Space (customer launches)	\$962M	+29.0%	(56.3)% ²
BA	Defense, Space & Security	\$7,500M	+13%	(0.2)% ⁵⁵
LMT	Space	\$3,496M	+5.7%	10.6% ⁵⁶

COMPANY	SEGMENT	Q2'26 REVENUE	Y/Y	MARGIN
NOC	Space Systems	\$2,753M	+4.0%	8.6% ⁵⁷

SpaceX ranks last on reported segment revenue only because its Space line excludes all 60 internal Starlink launches of the half, whose costs are capitalized into satellites; its satellite broadband Connectivity margin of 38.6% runs about 3.6x Lockheed's 10.6%, the best space-segment margin here ². RTX and General Dynamics disclose no space segment. Boeing discloses growth only to the whole percent.

Share in 12-18 months

No measurement firm publishes a per-provider tally for satellite broadband or AI cloud, and neither market carries a sized estimate in our evidence, so growth there rests on subscriber and capacity counts; BryceTech's Q1 2026 briefing gives regional totals only ⁵⁸. Launch share holds above half of global orbital launches through 2027 [ESTIMATE]: Vulcan and New Glenn can add only a few flights a quarter once they return, and Arianespace aims at six to eight fully expendable Ariane 6 flights in all of 2026 ⁵⁹. Starlink reaches 18–20 million subscribers by end-2027 [ESTIMATE], below the 20.4–22.2 million that extrapolating Q1 and Q2 net adds of 1.4 million and 1.7 million would give ¹⁵, because TMF Associates puts network capacity near 20 million [ESTIMATE, June 5, 2026] ⁶⁰ and we assume net adds decelerate as that ceiling binds. Chinese operators plan more than 4,000 satellites a year from 2028, foreclosing third-country markets without a bid ⁶¹.

SWOT

RANKED ITEMS	
Strengths	51% of 2025 orbital launches and 85% of satellites; Connectivity margin 38.6%, ~3.6x Lockheed's space segment; \$6.45B of Golden Dome awards, above all others combined
Weaknesses	Space margin (56.3)% on \$962M; \$47.5B backlog across three segments vs CoreWeave's ~\$104B in one; one Starship flight in 1H'26 versus three, gating V3 capacity
Opportunities	\$185B Golden Dome program, procurement at full scale after 2028 ³⁹ ; launch pool \$11.82B (2025) to \$24.42B (2030); Viasat US base 603,000 to 115,000, HughesNet parent in Chapter 11
Threats	Google contract terminable on 90 days after December 31, 2026; Amazon Leo launch and \$11.57B Globalstar close in 2027; Chinese constellations at 4,000+ a year from 2028

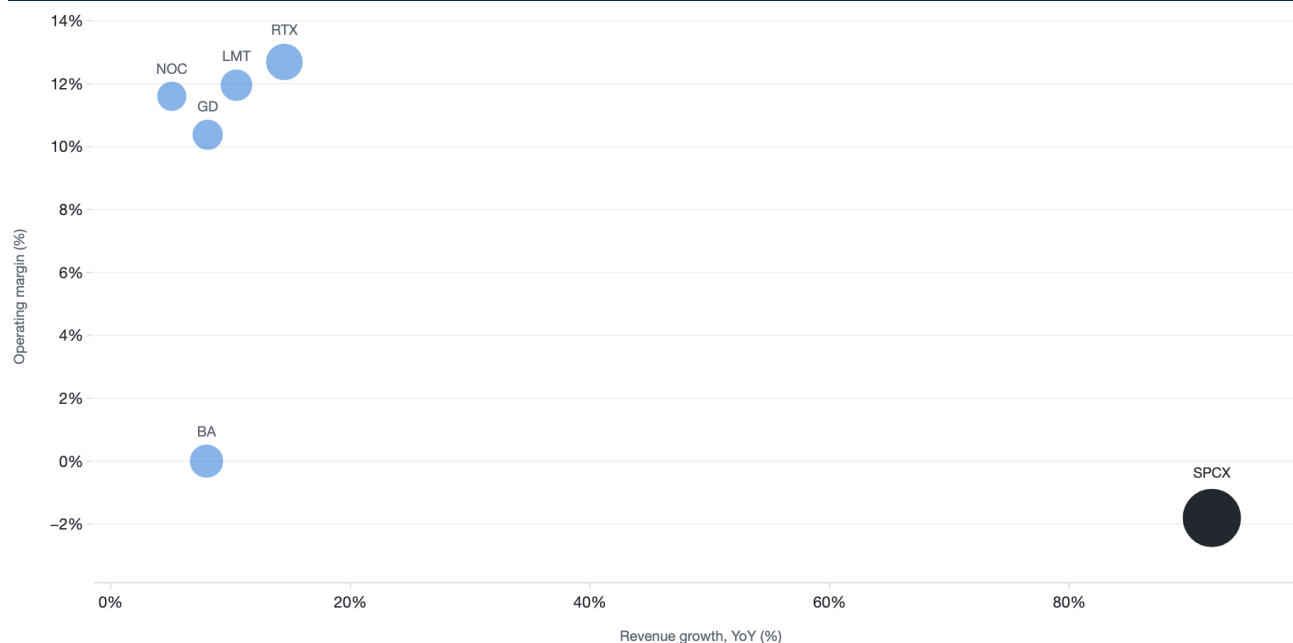


Exhibit 1 — SPCX plots at 91.9% revenue growth and a -1.8% operating margin against its five defense-prime comparables (BA, LMT, RTX, NOC, GD), with marker area showing market capitalization. Source: Yahoo Finance, as of 2025-12-31; six companies plotted.

4. Supply Chain Positioning

At June 30, 2026 SpaceX carried \$27.96 billion of non-cancelable contractual commitments, \$22.24 billion of it in calendar 2027 alone, against AI cloud revenue either party may terminate on 90 days' notice.² It makes most of what it flies, so parts and logistics exposure is small; the two inputs it cannot make are GPUs and power.

Upstream: the NVIDIA allocation

Supplier concentration in the AI segment is voluntary and unhedged. On the August 4, 2026 call management said “we’re exclusive to NVIDIA,” describing the allocation behind it as an “understanding” that SpaceX “will receive a very significant percent of their GPUs next year.”¹⁵ No binding allocation agreement is disclosed, and the 10-Q says supplier contracts “generally do not have long-term binding and enforceable purchase orders,” so future purchases may create material cash commitments.² No filing gives any supplier as a share of cost of revenue, so the concentration cannot be sized from disclosure.

Second-quarter capital expenditure was \$18,369 million, \$15,828 million (86.2%) of it in the AI segment per the filed segment table, with the next two quarters guided to a similar level (guidance, Q2 2026 call).²¹⁵ Spending at that rate against an unwritten allocation converts a supplier delay into stranded shell and power. If SpaceX misses the committed GPU count to Google by September 30, 2026, Google may terminate after a one-month grace period or take fewer GPUs at reduced fees.¹¹ Management names memory as the real bottleneck, output growing about 20% a year against demand near 200% (Musk’s estimate, same call), with no

memory supplier relationship disclosed.¹⁵ A memory-constrained allocation would not relieve the 2027 commitments; it would push revenue-earning compute later while depreciation runs, compressing AI margin in the year spending peaks.

Committed spend against terminable revenue

Commitments are front-loaded: \$2.73 billion in the remainder of 2026, \$22.24 billion in 2027 (79.6% of the total on our arithmetic), \$2.17 billion in 2028 and \$0.81 billion in 2029 and thereafter, attributed primarily to AI infrastructure, third-party cloud capacity and the EchoStar spectrum deal.² Cloud services agreements, after an initial ramp, “may be terminated by either party upon 90 days’ notice,” on the monthly terms Section 2 sets out.²

Management says it can reduce and reallocate data center capital expenditure if demand ramps slowly,² but the 2027 outflow is non-cancelable while the revenue is not. The commitments and the capital program run on different clocks. Only \$2.73 billion of the rest of the 2026 program is committed, against the roughly \$65 billion Section 5 sizes for the year, so almost all of this year’s spending can still be stopped. The bind is 2027, where \$22.24 billion is contractual against AI revenue running at \$10.2 billion a year behind a 90-day termination right. We read this as a schedule and margin risk rather than a solvency one, since commitments equal 26.6% of the cash, securities and undrawn revolving capacity Section 5 details, and 28.0% of cash and securities alone.² If a customer exercises the 90-day right, the depreciation base keeps running against revenue that stops.

Power and the turbine schedule

Nameplate compute draw reached 1.4 gigawatts at June 30, 2026 from 0.4 a year earlier, with over 2 gigawatts targeted by year-end 2026 and management pointing to “closer to 10 gigawatts of compute than 5” by end-2027 [GUIDANCE, Q2 2026 call, August 4, 2026].²¹⁵ The 20 gigawatt figure quoted on the same call is a tentative power-and-cooling target management does not expect to hit, against roughly 15 gigawatts expected.¹⁵

The Southaven plant is late, on the July 30, 2026 agreed order Section 7 details: the 41 permitted stationary turbines behind 1.2 gigawatts slip while 69 temporary mobile units carry the site.⁶² No filing discloses how much Colossus II load the mobile units carry, so the megawatts at risk cannot be sized.² Management is over-building the cheaper input, targeting “far more power, cooling and electrical equipment than we have GPUs,” which lifts fixed cost per GPU-hour when allocation slips.¹⁵

Starship

The Flight 12 failure and the FAA review that followed are set out in Section 7; there is no active grounding. Throughput carried the cost: one Starship launch in H1 2026 against three in H1 2025, and customer payload mass of 132 metric tons against 163.² Consolidated impairment

was \$0 in Q2 and H1 2026, since test hardware is expensed as incurred and a lost vehicle lands in Space R&D.² The residual exposure is schedule, since Starship gates the mobile satellites the EchoStar payoff depends on.¹⁵

Working capital

Days inventory outstanding fell to about 70.8 days in Q2 2026 from about 93.3 in fiscal 2025 (ended December 31, 2025) and 91.4 in fiscal 2024, while days sales outstanding rose to about 41.9 days from 30.9 and 27.4 (our estimates, as of August 12, 2026).²⁶³⁶⁴ Segment mix drives the improvement: the AI segment holds almost no inventory, its assets landing in property, plant and equipment, where servers and networking gear rose to \$34.8 billion from \$22.7 billion in six months.² Inventory rose 12.5% in the six months from December 31, 2025 to \$2.72 billion, finished goods up 23.7% to \$721 million, the line to watch if Starlink Kit sell-through slows.²

Receivables more than doubled to \$3.60 billion, a \$2,003 million working-capital drag in the half against \$470 million a year earlier, more than offset by \$2,169 million of deferred revenue from upfront Space and Connectivity payments.² Contract-billed cloud customers are displacing consumer direct debits, concentrating cash timing in the counterparties holding the 90-day termination right. Payables fell to \$8.24 billion from \$11.79 billion, but \$5,513 million of that balance is unpaid property, plant and equipment, so a cost-based payables measure is meaningless.²

Customer concentration and channels

Two customers cleared 10% of consolidated revenue in Q2 2026: Customer A at 18.3%, up from 16.7% a year earlier and spanning all three segments, and Customer B at 19.5% from below 10%, in the AI segment only, a combined 37.8%.² Customer B's 12.2% half-year share implies essentially all of its first-half revenue landed in Q2, and on our estimate it is about 59.5% of AI segment revenue.² Neither is named; we infer the U.S. government, reported at about one-fifth of 2025 sales, and Anthropic.⁶⁵

Losing Customer B on 90 days' notice would remove close to a fifth of consolidated revenue, and the CFO said the new hosting deals "generated high incremental EBITDA margins," so the EBITDA loss would be proportionally larger.¹⁵ Consumer broadband is month-to-month, AI advertising and subscriptions are short-term, and mobile customers "can generally terminate at any time."² Only Space carries duration, up to fourteen years for launch and development work, and that base is thin, at the 17 customer launches of 77 Falcon flights in H1 2026 given in Section 3.² Space revenue rests on a handful of missions a quarter, so one slipped launch moves the segment line.

Geography, trade and vertical integration

The footprint is overwhelmingly domestic, and the concentrated geographic risk is legal, sitting in one Memphis-area power cluster. Tariff exposure is disclosed but never sized: customs and duties appear only as an unquantified component of Connectivity cost of revenue, \$2.06 billion

in Q2 2026, with no share, no rate, no import value and no country-of-origin split, and the filing never uses the word tariff.² The filing names no ITAR, export-control or sanctions regime, a disclosure gap for a launch and satellite manufacturer.

Vertical integration has removed input risk where the input was scarce. Upgraded Starlink satellites fly argon Hall thrusters in place of krypton units, retiring a dependence on a thin rare-gas market.⁶⁶ Linde is building a \$100 million air separation unit in Brownsville to supply liquid oxygen, nitrogen and argon beside Starbase.⁶⁷⁶⁸ Both convert a purchased input into an owned fixed cost, lowering unit cost at volume but raising operating leverage if cadence disappoints. Related-party supply is growing, at \$295 million of Tesla Megapack products in Q2 and \$329 million in the half, recorded in property, plant and equipment.² Grid storage therefore runs through an affiliate on terms the filing does not benchmark, the one supplier relationship where price is not tested by an arm's-length counterparty.

5. Financial Strength

SpaceX has not produced a genuine operating profit in any filed period, and first-half 2026 capital expenditure ran at 227.7% of revenue. The February 2026 xAI merger was a common-control transaction: fiscal years 2023 through 2025 (each ending December 31) recast SpaceX, xAI and X as one company, and no standalone series exists.²²⁴

Revenue, margins and cash conversion

\$M	FY2023	FY2024	FY2025	H1 2025	H1 2026
Revenue	10,387	14,015	18,674	8,138	12,508
Gross margin	41.2%	42.9%	49.4%	47.8%	53.0%
Operating income	(3,505)	466	(2,589)	(943)	(2,086)
Operating margin	(33.7)%	3.3%	(13.9)%	(11.6)%	(16.7)%
Net income (loss)	(4,628)	791	(4,937)	(1,536)	(4,817)
Operating cash flow	4,520	5,776	6,785	351	3,466
Capital expenditure	(4,415)	(11,163)	(20,906)	(6,965)	(28,476)
Free cash flow	+105	(5,387)	(14,121)	(6,614)	(25,010)
Stock-based compensation	679	784	1,947	694	1,470

Annual columns are the provider series, half-year columns the Q2 10-Q; operating income is after unusual items.⁶⁴⁶⁹²

Revenue grew 34.9% in fiscal 2024, 33.2% in fiscal 2025 and 53.7% year-over-year in the first half of 2026, and gross margin widened 11.8 points, yet neither produced an operating profit. Fiscal 2023's loss carries a \$3,811 million impairment charge.⁶⁹ Fiscal 2024's 3.3% margin is the only positive print, and net income of \$791 million rests on pre-tax income of \$242 million, helped by a \$549 million tax benefit and \$985 million of other non-operating income.⁶⁴ Fiscal 2025 reversed as research and development more than doubled to \$8,643 million. Growth is being bought with operating expense. The second quarter's net loss was \$(541) million, or \$(0.09) per share basic and diluted, against \$(1.12) for the first half on 4,879 million weighted average shares.²³

Conversion ratios are not meaningful: net income is a loss in four of the five periods, and fiscal 2024's 7.3x operating cash flow to net income measures non-cash addbacks. SpaceX turns large net losses into positive operating cash, then turns that cash into a far larger deficit through capex.

Depreciation and amortization was \$5,290 million, \$2,848 million of it in the second quarter, or 36.4% of second-quarter revenue.² Deferred revenue supplied \$2,169 million, 62.6% of all operating cash flow, against a \$14,286 million balance, and that float reverses if bookings flatten. Receivables rose from \$1,579 million to \$3,596 million over the half, a \$2,003 million drag, and Section 4 measures the days-sales-outstanding extension. Two non-operating items shape the half: a \$1,545 million loss on debt extinguishment from the bridge repayment, 32% of the \$4,817 million net loss and the largest reconciling item between operating and net loss, and a \$539 million unrealized loss on a \$1,098 million digital-asset position marked through earnings, against a \$252 million gain a year earlier.

Stock-based compensation is a real cost and it is compounding, from \$679 million in fiscal 2023 to \$1,947 million in fiscal 2025, with the first half's \$1,470 million equal to 11.8% of revenue.² Second-quarter adjusted EBITDA of \$3,538 million sits \$3,681 million above the \$(143) million operating loss purely on depreciation and stock compensation. Reported earnings understate cash generation at the operating line and overstate it badly once capex is included.

Depreciation life and the payback claim

Management told the second-quarter call that new compute has a "less than 1 year payback."¹⁵ SpaceX's own depreciation says otherwise. Gross property and equipment excluding construction-in-progress averaged \$60,608 million over the half, and first-half depreciation of \$5,064 million annualizes to \$10,128 million against it, an implied composite life of about 6.0 years, and 5.1 years for servers and data-center infrastructure [ESTIMATE, as of 2026-08-12].² Those claims reconcile only if new compute returns roughly five times its cost in cash over that life. The cash test is the relevant one and it fails: AI segment adjusted EBITDA of \$1,146 million in the second quarter annualizes to \$4.6 billion against \$15,828 million of AI capital expenditure in that quarter alone, so a single quarter's spending takes about 3.5 years to pay back at the current rate [ESTIMATE, as of 2026-08-12] (Sections 2 and 4).²³²

On the \$34,771 million of gross servers and networking equipment at June 30, 2026, straight-line, a six-year life costs \$5,795 million a year and a three-year life \$11,590 million.² Shortening the assumption on today's base adds about \$5.8 billion of annual depreciation, more than the first-half net loss [ESTIMATE, as of 2026-08-12]. We treat the life assigned to servers and data-center infrastructure as the most likely accounting revision in a future filing, because the cloud contracts behind the AI revenue cancel on 90 days' notice while that hardware runs five to six years. Section 6 reaches the opposite conclusion on the satellite fleet, whose depreciation matches its design life.

Return on capital

We derive ROIC as reported operating income (NOPAT, since cash taxes are near zero) over invested capital: debt and finance leases plus equity including mezzanine preferred, less cash and marketable securities.

\$M	FY2024	FY2025	H1 2026 ANNUALIZED
Operating income	466	(2,589)	(4,172)
Debt and finance leases	14,175	22,896	39,364
Equity plus mezzanine preferred	25,804	41,325	127,224
Less cash and securities	(12,185)	(24,747)	(100,009)
Invested capital	27,794	39,474	66,579
ROIC	+1.7%	(6.6)%	(6.3)%

Fiscal 2024 inputs are the provider balance sheet, including its \$800 million of other short-term investments⁶³; 2025 debt and the 2026 column are the 10-Q's carrying amounts rather than the provider's wider debt definition.² The zero tax rate follows a \$29 million provision on a \$4,788 million first-half pre-tax loss, \$35 million of cash tax paid and a full US valuation allowance; a notional 21% would flatter the losses to (5.2)% and (5.0)%. Fiscal 2023 ROIC is not computable for want of a 2023 balance sheet.

We estimate cost of capital at roughly 11% to 12% [ESTIMATE, as of 2026-08-12], on a 4.72% 10-year Treasury at August 10, 2026⁷⁰, an assumed 5.0% equity risk premium and a forward beta near 1.5. Section 6 measures a 3.83 regression beta over 41 trading days of price history, and both routes land near 12%.¹⁷ SpaceX earns roughly 17 to 18 points below that hurdle, destroying \$11 billion to \$12 billion of value a year on \$66.6 billion of invested capital [ESTIMATE, as of 2026-08-12], and the gap widened as invested capital more than doubled.

Bulls will point to segment ROIC, but no segment invested capital is disclosed, since the chief operating decision maker does not evaluate segments on assets (Note 18). First-half segment operating income was +\$2,844 million for Connectivity against \$(1,204) million for Space and

\$(3,726) million for AI.² Connectivity alone would clear a 12% hurdle, but we weight the consolidated figure, because capital is raised and serviced at the parent and management chooses the cross-subsidy.

Operating leverage

Incremental margins are high and the fixed base is heavy. Revenue rose \$3,120 million between the first and second quarters of 2026 while the operating loss narrowed from \$(1,943) million to \$(143) million, an incremental operating margin of 57.7% [ESTIMATE, as of 2026-08-12].² A 10% shortfall against the second-quarter run rate, about \$781 million, would cost roughly \$451 million of operating income at that rate [ESTIMATE, as of 2026-08-12], more than three times the quarter's operating loss. Year-over-year that leverage is consumed as fast as it arrives, with first-half revenue up \$4,370 million while the operating loss widened \$1,143 million on \$3,547 million more research and development.

Leverage, maturities and covenants

Debt and finance leases reached \$39,364 million at June 30, 2026, up 71.9% in six months, against \$93,522 million of cash and \$6,487 million of marketable securities, so the company is net cash by roughly \$60.6 billion.² Management states no material principal is due until July 15, 2031 under the SpaceX Notes, and Note 9 qualifies that: \$13,232 million, or 34.4% of the \$38,433 million outstanding, falls due before 2031, starting with \$944 million in the rest of 2026.

Almost all of that near-dated paper is related-party equipment financing. Related-party debt is \$13,329 million, 33.9% of the total, structured as failed sale-leasebacks on AI infrastructure with Valor Equity Partners, whose founder sits on the board, and it grew from \$4,507 million at December 31, 2025.² Related-party interest of \$327 million in the second quarter was 52.0% of the \$629 million total. Note 9 discloses a 5.9% average fixed rate on other financing arrangements, but \$327 million a quarter implies roughly 9.8% on the ending balance and 14.7% on the average balance. The two cannot both describe the same cash cost, and we take the effective cost as materially above 5.9%.

The undrawn \$5,000 million revolver, maturing May 19, 2031, caps the Consolidated Leverage Ratio at 3.75 to 1.00 each quarter end, and the company reports compliance at June 30, 2026.² Trailing adjusted EBITDA on its definition is about \$8,355 million [ESTIMATE, as of 2026-08-12], from fiscal 2025's \$6,634 million plus first-half 2026's \$4,665 million less first-half 2025's \$2,944 million; our fiscal 2025 leg ties to the \$6.6 billion reported from the S-1.²⁴ Gross debt against it is 4.7x and would breach the test, while on net debt the ratio is negative, so headroom is a function of the cash balance and erodes with the capex program. A February 2026 technical default on assumed xAI debt was waived on March 2, 2026. EBIT interest coverage was negative in every period except fiscal 2024, at 0.29x, and second-quarter interest income of \$340 million offsets 54.1% of interest expense.

Capital allocation and cash sensitivity

SpaceX has never returned capital and has been a serial issuer of it. No dividend is declared. We read the \$4,426 million of first-half “repurchases” as consideration mechanics inside the common-control combination and pre-IPO employee liquidity, not capital return; the fiscal 2024 and 2025 analogues were \$1,021 million and \$1,125 million.²⁶⁹ Issuance runs the other way, at \$85,675 million of net IPO proceeds and \$51,812 million of financing proceeds in the first half of 2026. Of the \$28,476 million of first-half capex, 82.7% went to AI, and \$3,921 million more of equipment was financed separately, lifting economic additions to about \$32.4 billion [ESTIMATE, as of 2026-08-12]. Management guided capex flat for two quarters, implying about \$65.2 billion for fiscal 2026 [ESTIMATE from GUIDANCE, Q2 2026 call, 2026-08-04]¹⁵, against a sell-side path of roughly \$46 billion [CONSENSUS, Benzinga survey, as of 2026-08].⁷¹ We weight management’s number, from the party writing the checks.

Financing execution looks disciplined. Deal pricing does not. Most of the capex program is not yet contracted, and Section 4 sets the commitment base against both denominators.² The EchoStar equity leg is fixed at a share count rather than a dollar amount and carries no collar, so the economic cost at spot runs far above the \$19.6 billion headline, at the figure Section 6 derives.²

Allocating first-half operating cash flow by adjusted EBITDA gives second-quarter operating cash of about \$2,628 million against \$18,369 million of capex, a burn of roughly \$15.7 billion a quarter and about 6.3 quarters of runway on \$100.0 billion of liquidity [ESTIMATE, as of 2026-08-12].² The two cloud anchors pay a combined \$2.17 billion a month on the terms and termination rights Section 2 sets out.²²¹¹ If that \$2.17 billion a month is not renewed, at a 75% incremental cash margin it costs about \$4.9 billion of quarterly operating cash, burn widens to roughly \$20.6 billion and runway compresses to about 4.8 quarters [ESTIMATE, as of 2026-08-12]. Free cash flow is set by the quarterly capex decision, and breakeven capex is roughly \$2.6 billion a quarter, 16.1% of the guided program.

Peer benchmark

TTM, AS OF 2026-08-12	OPERATING MARGIN	ROIC	DEBT/ EBITDA	INTEREST COVERAGE	FREE CASH FLOW
SPCX	(14.9)%	(6.3)% (derived)	7.5x	(1.6)x	(\$32.5B)
BA	(5.4)%	(12.7)%	7.1x	1.8x	(\$0.2B)
LMT	10.9%	27.4%	1.9x	8.2x	\$8.7B
RTX	12.3%	9.4%	2.6x	6.2x	\$11.4B

Every cell except the SpaceX ROIC is the provider’s reported field per stockanalysis.com.⁷²⁷³⁷⁴⁷⁵ The (14.9)% trailing operating margin here is the figure we use; the (1.8)% printed in the Peer Comparison table at the front of this report is a different provider field that does not reconcile to the filings. SpaceX’s 7.5x runs on the provider’s \$5.3 billion trailing EBITDA, while the 4.7x above runs on the company’s larger adjusted EBITDA. Only Boeing shares the negative return profile, and it is levered while SpaceX is net cash.

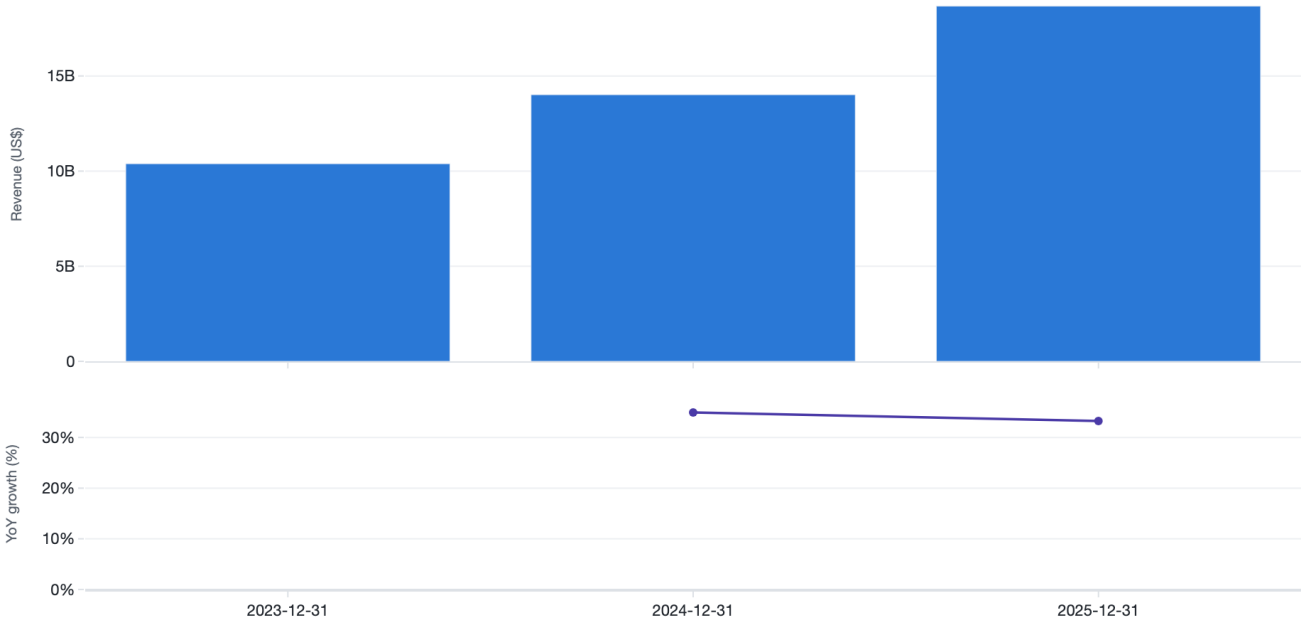


Exhibit 2 — Annual revenue reached \$18.7B for the year ended 2025-12-31, up 33.2% year on year across three reported years. Source: Yahoo Finance; the series stops at 2025-12-31 and so predates the recast 2026 quarters this section works from.

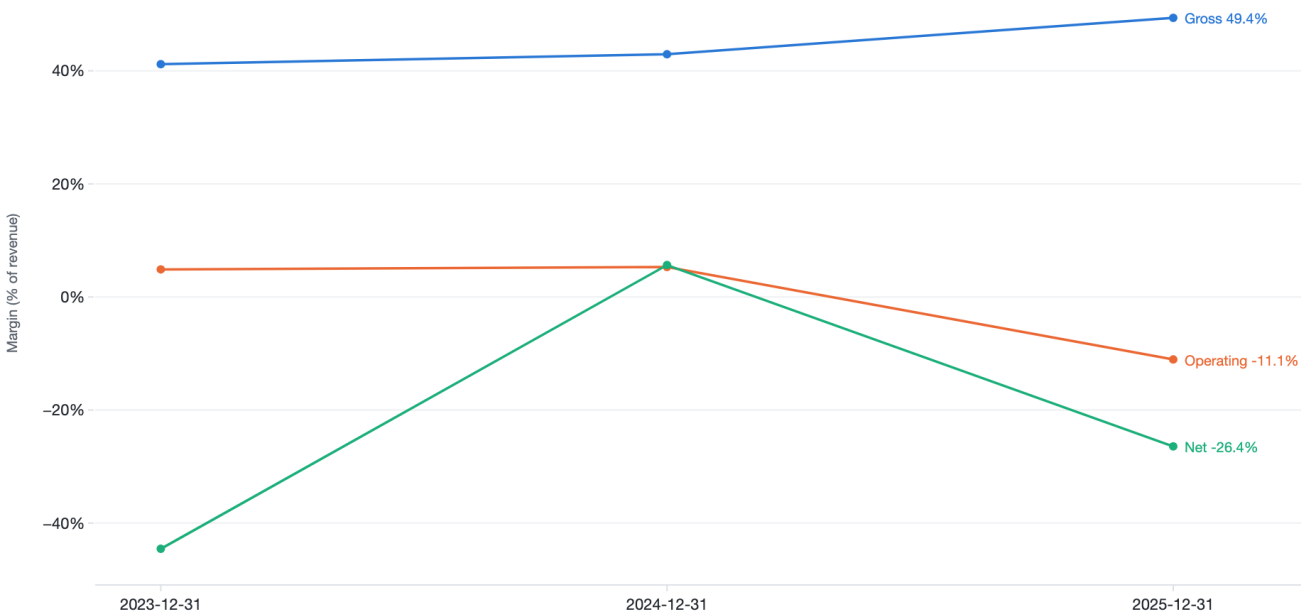


Exhibit 3 — Gross margin of 49.4% falls to a -11.1% operating margin and a -26.4% net margin for the year ended 2025-12-31, on the provider's operating-income basis: the gross profit is consumed entirely below the gross line. Source: Yahoo Finance, three reported years through 2025-12-31.

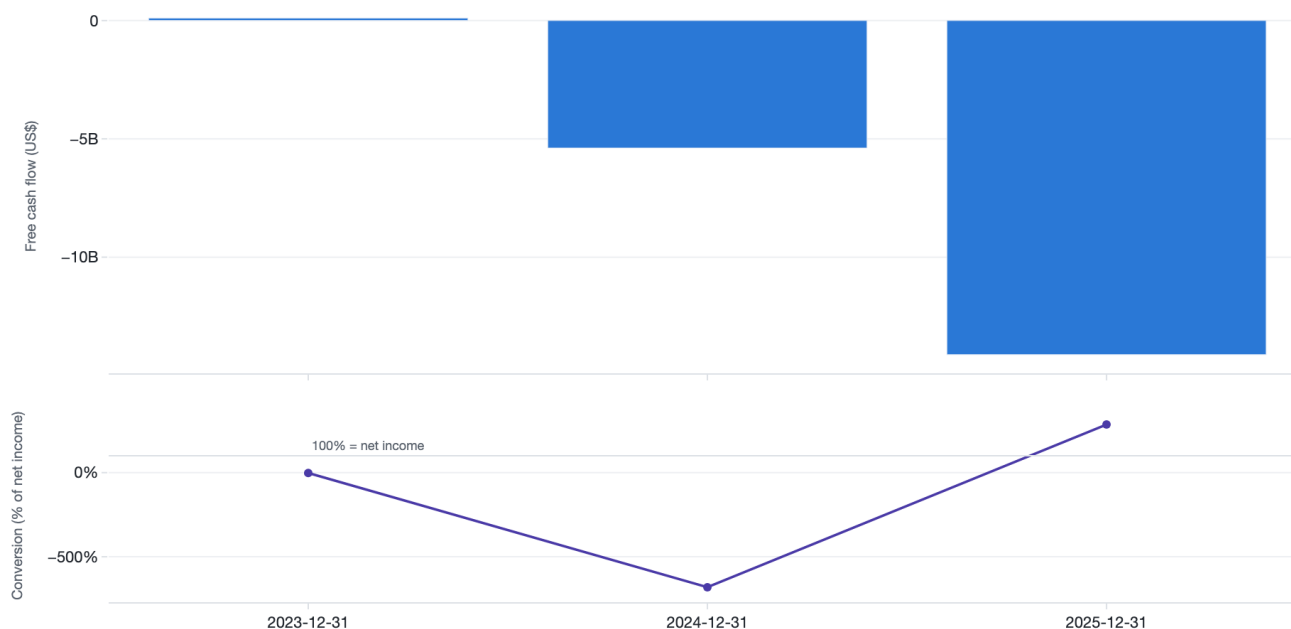


Exhibit 4 — Free cash flow of -\$14.1B for the year ended 2025-12-31, or 286.0% of net income, is the gap between what operations generate and what the capital program spends. Source: Yahoo Finance, three of three years with cash-flow data.

6. Valuation

We value the equity at \$38.13 per share on a ten-year discounted cash flow at a 12% weighted average cost of capital, 71.4% below the August 11, 2026 close of \$133.29 [ESTIMATE, this report, as of August 12, 2026].²⁷⁶¹⁷ The fiscal year ends December 31.⁶⁴ The EchoStar spectrum purchase and the cost of replacing the satellite fleet move that figure inside a \$36 to \$42 band. A second frame values 2028 adjusted EBITDA at an exit multiple and returns \$119.40 in its base case. Morningstar values launch and Starlink alone at roughly \$40 per share, within \$2 of our cash-flow base.⁷⁷

Our fair value is \$38.13 per share and our probability-weighted scenario value is \$125.94 per share, and we do not average them. They differ on one question: whether the capital that builds the business is charged against the value of it. Our cash-flow model charges it. The scenario model capitalizes segment adjusted EBITDA, a measure management defines to exclude all depreciation, share-based compensation and restructuring charges. We rate off the cash-flow figure. The scenario frame stays in this section as a description of what buyers at \$133.29 are paying.²¹⁷

Enterprise value and the multiple set

Enterprise value is \$1.70 trillion: market capitalization of \$1.76 trillion, plus \$39.4 billion of debt and finance leases at June 30, 2026, less \$100.0 billion of cash and marketable securities.⁷⁸² Screens printing near \$3.45 trillion have double-counted equity value, and stockanalysis.com prints \$1.70 trillion on the same date.²⁵⁷²

On that base, EV/revenue is 73.6x trailing twelve-month revenue of \$23.0 billion.²⁵⁷² It is 38.1x consensus revenue of \$44.58 billion for fiscal 2026 (Yahoo Finance, 16 analysts, as of August 12, 2026) and 17.8x consensus of \$95.49 billion for fiscal 2027 (17 analysts, same date).⁷⁶ EV/EBITDA is 320.8x on stockanalysis.com's trailing twelve-month EBITDA, the basis the peer table below uses, and 287.7x on the Yahoo-derived \$5.90 billion.⁷²²⁵ Trailing net income is negative \$8.9 billion, so no trailing P/E exists, and a screened PEG of 0.34 is not usable on a \$0.09 earnings base.²⁵⁷² Forward P/E is 1,448x on fiscal 2026 consensus EPS of \$0.09 and 101.2x on fiscal 2027's \$1.32. Two providers publish 71.9x and 55.4x from bases that reconcile to neither.²⁵⁷⁶⁷²

Only the 17.8x on fiscal 2027 revenue looks normal, and its denominator does not survive inspection. Fiscal 2027 consensus EPS of \$1.32 on 13.18 billion shares implies roughly \$17.4 billion of net income and an 18.2% net margin, from a company that ran an operating loss in the first half of 2026 (Section 5).⁷⁶²

Valuation history, volatility and liquidity

SpaceX has 41 trading days of price history, June 12 to August 11, 2026, so no three-to-five-year average multiple exists.¹⁷ The record runs from a \$135.00 IPO price to a closing high of \$211.39 on June 16 and a closing low of \$108.27 on August 5, and spot sits 36.9% below the high and 1.3% below the IPO price.¹⁷² The stock has round-tripped its entire public life while consensus estimates doubled, so the market has been repricing the multiple rather than the forecast.

Realized annualized volatility over those 41 days is 107.6% against 13.1% for the S&P 500, with correlation of 0.47 and a regression beta of 3.83.¹⁷ Providers publish no five-year beta, and 41 observations cannot produce a stable one, but they rule out a beta near 1.0. We use a 12% WACC, with 10% and 15% sensitivities below.

Insiders hold 46.4% and institutions 7.5%, and 20-day average volume is 103.6 million shares.⁷² The two available float readings differ by a factor of four. stockanalysis.com reports a float of 155.63 million shares, which sits below its own short-interest count of 165.05 million.⁷² S3 Partners put short interest at 219.3 million shares and \$24.6 billion in the week of August 3, 2026, at roughly 34% of the public float, which implies a float near 640 million shares.⁷⁹⁸⁰ We use the S3 base.

Peer benchmark

COMPANY	EV	EV/SALES	EV/EBITDA	P/E	FORWARD P/E
SPCX	\$1,696.7B	73.6x TTM / 17.8x FY2027E	320.8x	n/a	101.2x FY2027E
Boeing	\$213.4B	2.27x	31.4x	87.0x	192.4x
Lockheed Martin	\$154.7B	2.01x	14.3x	22.0x	19.3x
RTX	\$332.3B	3.55x	22.3x	39.4x	30.4x
Northrop Grumman	\$96.1B	2.24x	15.7x	18.3x	19.7x
General Dynamics	\$111.0B	2.02x	16.8x	23.9x	22.3x
CoreWeave	\$95.3B	12.56x	24.8x	n/a	n/a
Nebius	\$49.7B	56.60x	1,357.7x	66.8x	n/a
Oracle	\$554.6B	8.23x	18.6x	25.0x	18.1x

EV/Sales, EV/EBITDA and P/E are trailing twelve months; forward P/E is next fiscal year. All figures as of August 12, 2026. [727374758182838485](#)

We use the defense primes only as a floor for the launch business, since their 2.24x median EV/sales on trailing revenue implies a share price under \$10. We take the AI-cloud set as the operative frame, and it does not rescue the stock, because SpaceX trades above CoreWeave, Nebius and Oracle on trailing sales. CoreWeave also warns on our exit multiple: its roughly 56% adjusted EBITDA margin collapses to about 1% adjusted operating margin once depreciation is charged. ⁸⁶

Consensus estimates and revisions

Consensus revenue runs \$36.80 billion to \$57.96 billion for fiscal 2026 and \$44.57 billion to \$148.69 billion for fiscal 2027. Consensus EPS is \$0.09 for fiscal 2026 from 13 analysts (negative \$1.02 to positive \$1.23) and \$1.32 for fiscal 2027 from 18 analysts (negative \$0.78 to positive \$4.84). ⁷⁶ A fiscal 2027 revenue high 3.3x the low is not forecasting error: two camps are pricing different companies, one underwriting the AI ramp and one assigning it nothing.

Revision levels moved violently and revision breadth did not move at all. Fiscal 2026 consensus EPS went from \$0.00 ninety days ago to negative \$1.90 at sixty days, negative \$0.58 at thirty days and positive \$0.09 today, a sign flip; fiscal 2027 roughly doubled over thirty days. ⁷⁶ Over the last thirty days, zero analysts raised and zero cut fiscal 2026, the only seven-day action was one cut, and fiscal 2027 saw a single raise. ⁸⁷ Coverage composition explains the gap, because the rating panel went from 11 analysts two months ago to 35 today, tripling when the quiet period expired around July 7. ⁸⁸⁸⁹ The multiple turns on this reconciliation: SpaceX is not cheap against a rising estimate, because consensus re-based on a changed

estimating population and no covering analyst has raised fiscal 2026 in a month.

Management's \$100 billion December ARR target (Section 2) exceeds the \$95.49 billion of fiscal 2027 consensus revenue, so the panel underwrites a full year of 2027 at roughly the run rate management expects in December 2026.¹⁵⁷⁶

Price targets and ratings

Targets run from \$62.00 (53.5% below spot) to \$800.00 (500.2% above), with a median of \$210.00 and a mean of \$235.69.⁸⁹ We read the 12.9x high-to-low ratio as the finding, and the mean's implied 76.8% upside hides it: the mean exceeds the median by \$25.69 almost entirely on one \$800.00 initiation on July 7, 2026. Nine firms published targets between \$210.00 and \$255.00, and the tails are Raymond James at \$800.00 and HSBC's \$115.00 hold.⁸⁹ Ratings are 6 strong buy, 22 buy, 5 hold and 2 sell, or 80% positive, against 6/21/6/2 a month ago.⁸⁸

Post-results actions are more cautious than the rating grid. The only two numeric target changes after the August 4 release were cuts, as Wells Fargo took \$230.00 to \$215.00 and Piper Sandler took \$156.00 to \$140.00, both holding their ratings.⁸⁹³⁰ Argus Research upgraded from hold to buy on August 7 with a \$160.00 target, \$75.69 below the panel mean.⁸⁹ We treat targets as a sentiment reading. Converted into our frame, the mean target implies 53.7x 2028 adjusted EBITDA and the median 47.7x, against the 30.0x embedded in spot.

The EchoStar spectrum and mobile

SpaceX is paying more for the EchoStar spectrum than the filing says, and the cost is dated and certain. Total consideration is disclosed as approximately \$19.6 billion: about \$11.1 billion in equity, payable in roughly 261.8 million Class A shares at a fixed value of \$42.40 per share, plus up to \$8.5 billion to pay off designated EchoStar debt.² Spectrum Credit Agreement payments of \$1,241 million in 2026 and \$828 million in 2027 take the filed figure to about \$21.7 billion.² Those same 261.8 million shares are worth \$34,895 million at the August 11 close, which puts the economic consideration at about \$45.5 billion [ESTIMATE, this report].¹⁷ Both numbers are true and we use the \$45.5 billion, because the agreement fixes a share count instead of a dollar amount and carries no collar, so the seller captured the entire move from \$42.40 to \$133.29. Dilution is 2.0% of the 13.18 billion shares outstanding, roughly \$2.65 per share transferred at spot before a single subscriber exists, and the Spectrum Acquisition Closing is expected on November 30, 2027.²³⁹⁰

For that cost to be NPV-neutral, mobile has to carry roughly \$1.6 billion of steady-state EBITDA at the 28.0x exit multiple used below, or \$6.5 billion at a 7.0x telecom multiple [ESTIMATE, this report]. No case we can build reaches \$6.5 billion, and two of the three clear \$1.6 billion, so the answer turns on which multiple mobile deserves. Today's service rides about 5 megahertz of borrowed bandwidth through telco partners and sells as a \$10 per month add-on, and we size three 2030 outcomes from it [ESTIMATE, this report, as of August 12, 2026].²¹⁵⁹¹⁹²

2030 CASE	MOBILE REVENUE	MOBILE EBITDA	VALUE PER SHARE
Wholesale layer, needs no spectrum	~\$2.2B	~\$1.4B	\$0.74 to \$2.98
Retail fourth carrier	~\$7.2B	~\$2.9B	\$1.54 to \$6.15
Hybrid supplemental coverage, the stated plan	~\$5.5B	~\$2.5B	\$1.33 to \$5.31

Value per share capitalizes 2030 mobile EBITDA at 7.0x to 28.0x on 13.18 billion shares, undiscounted.

The \$45.5 billion of spot-valued consideration is \$3.45 per share on 13.18 billion shares. At SpaceX's own 28.0x the retail and hybrid cases clear that; at a carrier's 7.0x none of the three does. We read the spectrum as value-neutral to slightly negative at today's price, because the case for it rests on mobile earning SpaceX's multiple rather than a carrier's. Crediting the benefit takes our cash-flow base from \$38.13 to roughly \$39 to \$42; charging the \$8.5 billion cash leg and the 2.0% dilution while crediting only the wholesale case takes it to about \$36. Mobile at even \$20 billion of 2035 revenue supplies 0.85% of the revenue the current price implies, so it does not close the gap to spot. Starlink Mobile sits unbroken inside Connectivity's enterprise and government line, so no direct-to-cell revenue, ARPU or subscriber figure is disclosed and the table above is a build with no reported line to reconcile to.²³⁰¹⁵

Satellite replacement and depreciation

The common bear thesis, that the P&L under-depreciates a constellation which physically has to be rebought, fails on the filing's own arithmetic. Satellites carry a gross value of \$13,788 million at June 30, 2026 against more than 10,200 in service, or \$1.35 million each including capitalized launch cost, since Starlink launches are capitalized into satellites instead of booked as inter-segment revenue.² An independent bottom-up estimate puts a V2 Mini plus its share of a Falcon 9 launch at \$1.4 million, 4% away.⁹³ Connectivity segment depreciation was \$805 million in the second quarter and \$1,588 million in the first half, or \$3,176 million annualized.² Divided into the average gross satellite balance over the half rather than the \$13,788 million June 30 figure, that charge implies a 4.1-year depreciable life if every dollar of it were satellites, and 5.1 years at an 80% satellite share [ESTIMATE, this report]. Reported depreciation on the satellite fleet is therefore consistent with a five-year design life, a finding that does not extend to the servers and data-center infrastructure Section 5 treats separately, and the almost 500 Starlink satellites retired in the first half of 2025 were all less than five years old.⁹⁴

Replacing today's fleet on a five-year life costs \$2.75 billion a year. A four-year life on a steady-state fleet of 15,000 costs \$5.63 billion, and a seven-year life on 12,000 costs \$2.31 billion, a bear-to-bull spread of \$3.32 billion a year [ESTIMATE, this report].² Capitalized as a perpetuity at a 12% WACC and 3.0% terminal growth, that spread is \$36.9 billion of enterprise value, or \$2.80 per share, ranging from \$2.10 at a 15% WACC to \$3.60 at 10%. Our cash-flow model already charges this spending, so fleet lifetime is a \$2 to \$4 question on a \$133.29 stock.

Connectivity's second-quarter segment adjusted EBITDA of \$2,597 million annualizes to \$10.39 billion and excludes the full \$805 million of quarterly segment depreciation, so the multiple frame charges nothing for rebuying the constellation.² Charging \$2.31 billion to \$5.63 billion against that \$10.39 billion is a 22.2% to 54.2% haircut. Undiscounted, at 28.0x on 13.18 billion shares, it is worth \$4.91 to \$11.96 per share of the \$119.40 scenario base, and it narrows the gap between our two base cases by 6% to 14% without closing it [ESTIMATE, this report]. Inside the discounted 13.9-billion-share frame the table below uses, the same base-life charge is \$5.16, and that is the figure the table applies. Replacement spending is immaterial to the cash-flow case because it is already charged, and material to the multiple case because it is not charged at all.

No useful life by asset class appears anywhere in the 10-Q, so the five-year life above is inferred. Satellite-only capital spending is not separable either, because Connectivity segment capital expenditures of \$1,367 million in the second quarter cover satellites, ground stations and research equipment together.²

Bear, base and bull

Each case values 2028 adjusted EBITDA less satellite sustaining capex of \$3.36 billion, the five-year-life charge on a 12,000-satellite 2028 fleet, at an exit multiple, adds \$60.6 billion of net cash, divides by roughly 13.9 billion fully diluted shares and discounts 2.4 years at 12%. Filing and provider agree at 13.18 billion shares today, and the pending Cursor and EchoStar issuances take the diluted count to roughly 13.9 billion.²³

SCENARIO	BEAR (30%)	BASE (50%)	BULL (20%)
2028 revenue	~\$95B	~\$165B	~\$260B
Adj. EBITDA margin	35%	48%	55%
2028 adj. EBITDA, after sustaining capex	~\$29.6B	~\$75.6B	~\$139.6B
Exit EV/EBITDA	15.0x, floored	28.0x	35.0x
Implied price	~\$40.00	\$119.40	\$271.20
Implied return	-70.0%	-10.4%	+103.5%

All three columns are our estimates as of August 12, 2026, built on second-quarter segment results, guidance and consensus.²¹⁵⁷⁶ The bear takes Section 7's 30% judgment on anchor-contract repricing in its sharpest form, with the Google contract lapsing at its first 90-day window and Anthropic repricing lower. At 15.0x that case gives \$27.69 mechanically, and we floor it near \$40 on the Morningstar core value cited above.⁷⁷ The base assumes both anchor contracts run to term, and its revenue path lands on 2027 consensus. The bull assumes a fleet

near 10 gigawatts, consistent with management's end-2027 target.¹⁵ Probability-weighting the three gives \$125.94. AI contract renewal is the variable the outcome is most sensitive to, ahead of compute lease-up, capex funding and Starlink pricing.

We bridge spot to the base with two legs on the same \$79 billion of uncharged 2028 adjusted EBITDA. Moving the exit multiple from the 30.0x in spot to 28.0x is worth \$8.64, and charging \$3.36 billion of satellite sustaining capex against that EBITDA at 28.0x is worth a further \$5.16. The two legs take the 30.0x in spot to the \$119.40 base, within rounding. No estimate-revision leg exists, because the market and our base agree on the operating trajectory.

We will not pay above 28.0x for EBITDA that add-backs manufacture: Section 2's AI segment adjusted EBITDA rests on adding \$1,885 million of depreciation and \$516 million of share-based compensation back to a \$1,257 million quarterly operating loss.² Our ten-year model returns \$38.13 per share at a 12% WACC, \$55.62 at 10% and \$23.76 at 15%, with 88% of enterprise value in terminal value because explicit-period free cash flow stays negative until 2030. Its base case carries fiscal 2027 revenue of \$110 billion decelerating to \$671 billion by 2035, a 25% terminal EBIT margin and 3.0% terminal growth; its bear case, at fiscal 2027 revenue of \$71 billion and a 16% terminal EBIT margin, gives \$6.41; its bull, at \$1.31 trillion of 2035 revenue and a 32% terminal margin, gives \$115.49 [ESTIMATE, this report, as of August 12, 2026].²⁷⁶ Capital expenditure in that base runs at 135% of revenue in fiscal 2026, nearer management's implied \$65.2 billion than the roughly \$46 billion sell-side path Section 5 sets against it, and declines to 22% of revenue in terminal. It carries no orbital-compute revenue or capital expenditure, so the option value Section 2 describes is zero here. Converted into the scenario frame, \$38.13 is about 8.0x 2028 adjusted EBITDA against the 30.0x in spot, and those 22 turns are the whole disagreement. On the same structure, \$133.29 requires 2035 revenue near \$2.35 trillion, or a 66% terminal EBIT margin, or a 6.63% WACC, the last below the 5.855% weighted-average coupon on the June 2026 notes.¹⁵ Management's own internal projection reaches \$1 trillion of revenue in 2030, pulled forward from 2031 with "a non-zero chance" of 2029 [GUIDANCE, Q2 2026 call, August 4, 2026].¹⁵ Run through our structure at a 25% terminal margin, that path is worth \$112.54 per share at a 12% WACC, and only an 11.02% cost of capital lifts it to spot [ESTIMATE, this report, as of August 12, 2026]. A buyer at \$133.29 is capitalizing management's most aggressive stated plan with essentially no probability haircut.

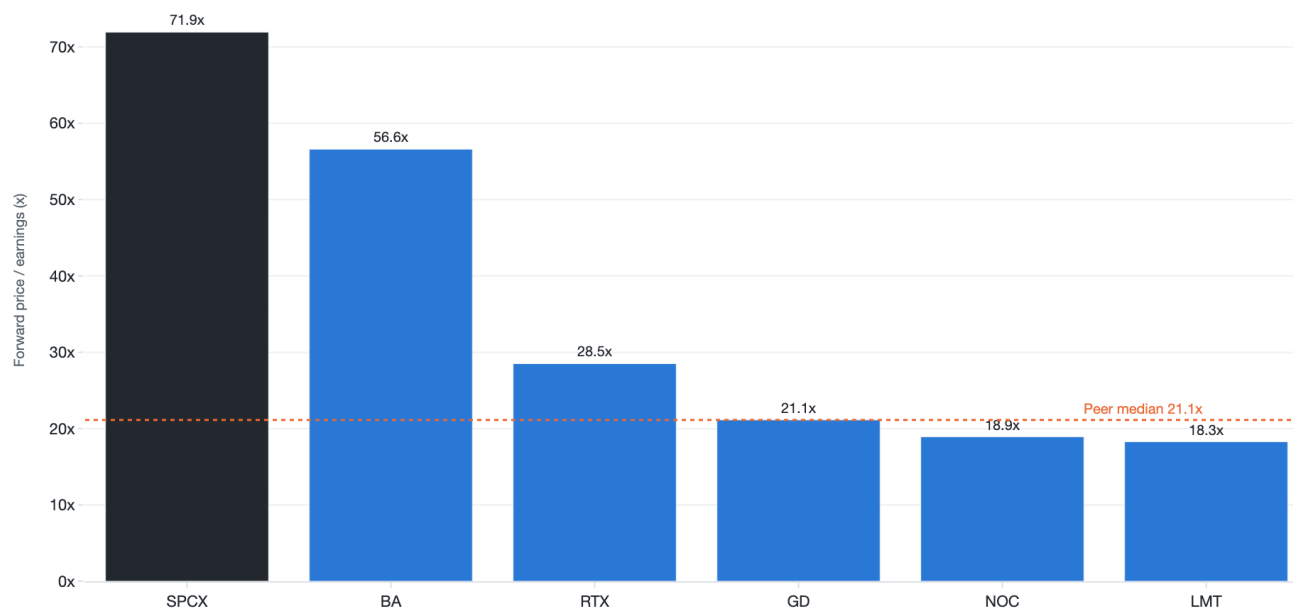


Exhibit 5 — SPCX trades at 71.9x forward earnings against a 21.1x median across five comparables. Source: Yahoo Finance, as of 2025-12-31; 71.9x is the provider's forward basis, which this section does not reconcile to its own consensus-EPS forward multiples.

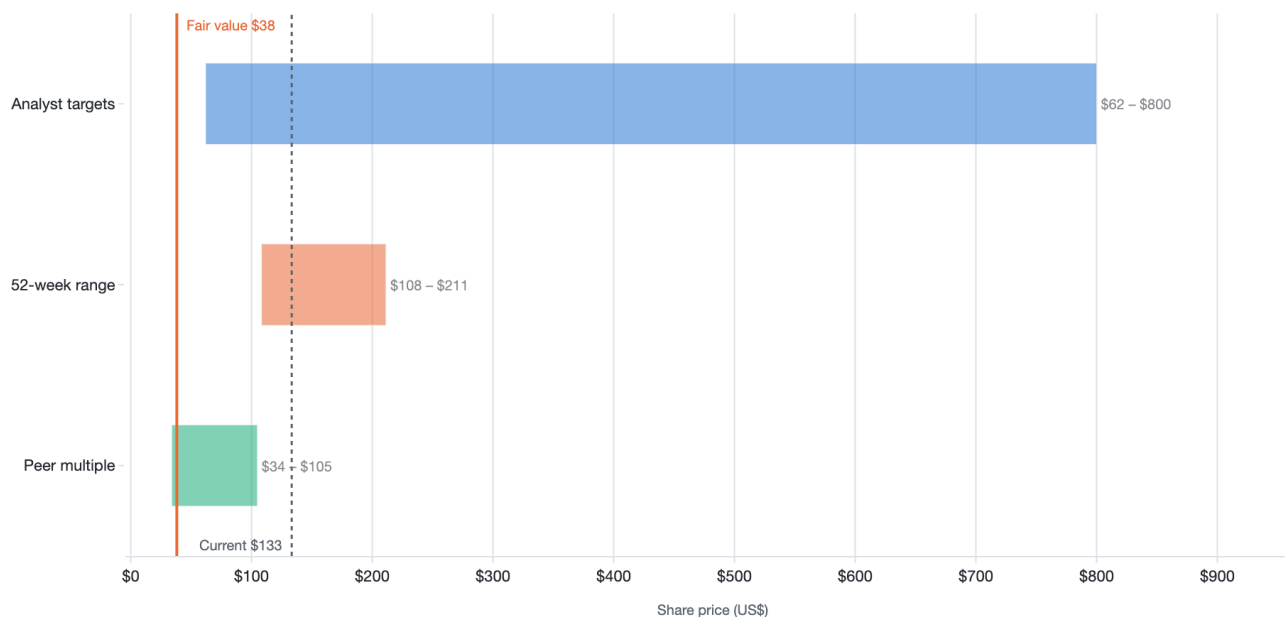


Exhibit 6 — Our \$38 fair value, a ten-year DCF at a 12% WACC cross-checked against a 2028 adjusted-EBITDA scenario frame and Morningstar's ~\$40 launch-and-Starlink value, sits below every band on the page: analyst targets \$62-\$800, the 52-week range \$108-\$211 and a peer multiple range of \$34-\$105, against \$133 today for an implied -71.4%. Sources: Yahoo Finance; fair value from this report's verdict.

7. Risks

Neither of the two largest risks appears in the accounts: \$22.2 billion of non-cancelable 2027 commitments (Section 4) sit against AI cloud revenue a customer can withdraw on 90 days' notice, and an uninsured constellation carries the only segment operating profit the company earns. Four more follow: lock-up supply through December, a Clean Air Act injunction that reaches AI compute power, key-man and political exposure, and litigation. SpaceX listed on June 12, 2026, so there is no 10-K and no Item 7A exposure table, and the Q2 2026 Form 10-Q gives market risk five sentences.⁶²

Customer terminability against fixed commitments

Part II Item 1A concedes that AI infrastructure revenue is "concentrated in a small number of customers" on cloud services agreements that "may be terminated by either party upon 90 days' notice."² Google's right opens after December 31, 2026, and no start date is disclosed for Anthropic's (Section 2), whose ramp ran May to June 2026, so that right may already be live.¹¹²²

Magnitude cannot be computed from disclosure, because the company gives neither a customer-level revenue split nor any minimum-commitment floor beneath the termination right, though Section 4 sizes the two customers that each cleared a tenth of consolidated revenue.² The first observable checkpoint is the Q3 print on November 3, 2026, measured against the December ARR target discussed in Section 2.⁹⁵¹⁵ We judge repricing at renewal more likely than outright cancellation, because moving installed capacity is slow, and we put roughly 30% on a material repricing or lapse of an anchor contract within twelve months [ESTIMATE, this report, as of August 12, 2026].

Constellation exposure and self-insurance

Connectivity earns the only segment operating profit in the company, on the second-quarter margin Section 2 sets out, so satellite physics is a claim on all of it.²

The S-1 states that the company "does not typically obtain insurance coverage for its satellites, payloads, or launch vehicles."⁹⁶ Self-insurance is rational here: fewer than 1% of active low-Earth-orbit satellites carry in-orbit cover, and a Starlink unit costs roughly \$400,000 in hardware against premiums running 1% to 3% of asset value.⁹⁷ Nothing sits between a fleet loss and the balance sheet.

A failure would also produce no visible write-off. Anomaly losses run through the Space segment's impairment line, which the filing describes as covering "impairment losses on fixed assets due to anomalies on the Company's flight vehicles and launch sites."² That line was zero in the first half of 2026 and \$29 million in the first half of 2025, and Starship test hardware is expensed as research and development within Space R&D of \$2,006 million for the half.² The damage arrives one or two quarters later as slipped revenue, which is why this risk has no accounting anchor for the market to price against.

The two constellation hazards we rank highest

The first is an undiagnosed systematic defect in one satellite model. Two Starlink satellites broke up on orbit in just over three months: unit 35956 on December 17, 2025, and unit 34343 on March 29, 2026 at roughly 560 km, less than a year after launch. LeoLabs assessed the second cause as internal to the satellite rather than a collision, and Jonathan McDowell noted that the failed unit was the newest model, V2 Mini Optimized, of which 3,532 were in orbit as of March 30, 2026.⁹⁸ Eight months after the first event, SpaceX has published no root cause.⁹⁹ Probability is low, since two events do not establish a pattern. If the family is defective, replacing all 3,532 units costs about \$4.8 billion at the \$1.35 million average carrying value per satellite, including capitalized launch, that Section 6 derives from the filing, against \$13,788 million of gross satellite property at June 30, 2026 [ESTIMATE, this report, as of August 12, 2026].² Insurance-market reporting puts the hardware alone near \$400,000 a unit, or \$1.4 billion for the family; we use the filed carrying value, because the launch has to be bought again too.⁹⁷ The observable trigger is a disclosed retirement or retrofit program for that model family, or a third breakup.

The second is Starship grounding frequency. Flight 12 lost a Raptor engine on May 22, 2026; the FAA determined a mishap on May 27 and required a SpaceX-led investigation, with FAA approval of the final report before the next flight.¹⁰⁰ The review closed on July 13, a grounding of roughly seven weeks, and Flight 13 flew on July 24, deploying 20 Starlink satellites while the booster was destroyed on its landing burn.¹⁰¹ Mishap investigations also followed the first four V1 flights and Flights 7 through 9, and the vehicle has still never reached orbit or recovered a booster.¹⁰⁰¹⁰¹ We put above 50% on at least one further multi-month stand-down before the end of 2027 [ESTIMATE, this report, as of August 12, 2026, from the observed mishap-per-flight ratio and the seven-week clock]. One anomaly gates Starlink V3, the Starlink orbital-compute satellites and the Artemis III lander at the same time, because all three ride the same vehicle.¹⁵⁹⁹ That prices as multiple compression. Falcon is the contrast: 684 full successes in 687 launches, and in its worst year three stand-downs inside eleven weeks, the longest about two weeks, so we put under 5% on a multi-month Falcon grounding in any year [ESTIMATE, this report, as of August 12, 2026].¹⁰²¹⁰³¹⁰⁴

Kessler-cascade risk, by contrast, is over-feared. Starlink executed 207,152 collision-avoidance maneuvers between December 2025 and May 2026, up from 148,696 in the prior half-year, at a threshold about 30 times stricter than industry convention.¹⁰⁵¹⁰⁶ The operational shells sit at 480 to 550 km, where drag clears uncontrolled debris over a few years, the same physics that reentered 38 of 49 Starlinks after a minor geomagnetic storm in February 2022.¹⁰⁶¹⁰⁷ A fragmentation event in those shells would not permanently deny the orbit, because a cascade needs debris that persists long enough to seed further collisions, which is far more plausible at 800 to 1,000 km. We price a multi-year disruption tail and no terminal-value impairment [ESTIMATE, this report, as of August 12, 2026; no source we hold quantifies a cascade threshold at these altitudes].

Lock-up supply

The 180-day block releases in stages: 20% of the block, roughly 911.5 million shares, freed on August 6, 2026, then 7% at the 70th, 90th, 105th, 120th and 135th days, then 28% two trading days after the Q3 print.¹⁰⁸ Published tranche sizes are estimates derived from that structure rather than a filed table.¹⁰⁹ There is no scheduled index bid against that supply: Nasdaq-100 inclusion was consumed on July 7, 2026, and S&P 500 entry is blocked until at least mid-2027 on seasoning and GAAP-profitability grounds.¹¹⁰¹¹¹

A conditional tranche of about 455.8 million shares required the stock to close 30% above the \$135.00 IPO price, at or above \$175.50, on five of the ten trading days ending on the first earnings release date.¹⁰⁸ Over that window, July 22 to August 4, closes ran from \$108.37 to \$125.33 and no session reached the trigger.¹⁷¹¹² Those shares roll into the December 8 residual, making it larger than the base-case tranche a reader would infer from the schedule [ESTIMATE, this report, as of August 12, 2026: the trigger and the miss are documented in our sources, the resulting tranche size is not].

Positioning into the first unlock was extreme, on the short interest and the conflicting float readings Section 6 reconciles [REPORTED, S3 Partners via Bloomberg, August 3, 2026].⁷⁹ The \$108.37 close of July 31 became \$114.92 on August 6 and \$133.11 on August 7, a 15.8% single-day gain.¹⁷ A market just taught that unlocks are harmless is precisely the market that under-prices a 28% tranche in November and an enlarged residual in December.

Colossus II power permitting

The Clean Air Act case over Colossus II reaches revenue, and the market reads it as an environmental headline. On April 14, 2026 the NAACP and its Mississippi State Conference sued X.AI Corp. and MZX Tech, LLC, alleging that the mobile gas turbines powering the site are unpermitted stationary sources, and a preliminary-injunction motion followed on May 6.² The case is No. 3:26-cv-00074-MPM-JMV (N.D. Miss.), and a federal judge is scheduled to hear the motion in late August 2026; no source we hold confirms a specific date.¹¹³⁶²

Exposure scales with turbine count, and the count is rising: the May 6 motion cited 33 turbines, and 69 were installed by August 2026 against 18 when the site started running.¹¹⁴⁶² Statutory penalties accrue per source per day, and third-party arithmetic puts one year of 27 unpermitted turbines above \$1.19 billion of theoretical exposure [ESTIMATE, third-party arithmetic].¹¹⁵ Removing turbines before the permanent plant is energized removes the power behind AI-segment revenue, and the litigation accrual discussed below is sized for damages only.² A July 30, 2026 agreed order with the Mississippi environmental regulator runs removal to July 2027 as a permanent 1.2 GW plant with 41 permitted turbines comes online, but it does not settle the stationary-source question.¹¹⁶⁶² We assess an injunction as unlikely given federal and state support, and as the sharpest single-day downside on the calendar if granted. No filing sizes the site's dependence on the mobile turbines, so we cannot put a revenue number on that outcome.

Key-man exposure and political retaliation

The S-1 calls Elon Musk the “driving force behind our growth, innovation, and operational success” and states that the company does “not maintain key-person life insurance on Mr. Musk.”¹¹⁷¹¹⁸ The space bench that would absorb his loss is deep: Gwynne Shotwell has been President since 2008, Bret Johnsen sole CFO since 2011, and vehicle, launch and Starship engineering sit with 15-to-20-year veterans, though the same reporting finds no disclosed succession plan.¹¹⁹ The vacuum is in AI. Every xAI co-founder had departed by March 27, 2026, with the cascade beginning right after the February 2, 2026 merger close, and an internal memo under new leadership cited model FLOPs utilization near 11% against a 35% to 45% industry range.¹²⁰¹²¹ His loss would therefore compress the multiple. Falcon, Dragon and Starlink would keep flying; Starship’s development cadence, the xAI turnaround and the capital-markets narrative would not survive intact.

On retaliation, June 2025 already ran the experiment. After the Trump-Musk rupture of June 5, 2025, Musk threatened to decommission Dragon and withdrew the threat within hours.¹²² On June 9 a senior official asked the Defense Department to inventory every SpaceX transaction agreement; officials concluded that most of the deals were critical, and the contracts remained in place.¹²³ Substitutability was the binding constraint, and SpaceX flew 11 of 12 medium- and heavy-lift National Security Space Launch missions in 2025.⁶⁵

The live exposure therefore runs the other way, as an unwinding of favorable treatment. The federal government currently intervenes on the company’s side in the Memphis turbine case,²¹²⁴ and the Golden Dome award book Section 3 sizes shows the benefit: the \$4.16 billion Space-Based Advanced Moving Target Indicator award alone exceeds the roughly \$3.2 billion prototype pool spread across eleven other firms.³⁹ That premium is marked nowhere in the filings, and it unwinds on a political timetable rather than a contractual one.

The fastest federal lever is FAA launch and reentry licensing under 14 CFR Part 450, exercised twice in 2026: the May 27 mishap determination above, and Flight 14’s tower catch, which proceeds only “assuming we receive regulatory approval to do so” [GUIDANCE, Q2 2026 call, August 4, 2026].¹⁰⁰¹⁵ On sizing, the unnamed customer spanning all three segments that Section 4 measures is consistent with the U.S. Government at roughly one-fifth of 2025 revenue, though the filing does not name it and that identification remains [UNVERIFIED].²¹²⁵ We put a determined federal squeeze at 8% to 12% of revenue impaired over 12 to 24 months [ESTIMATE, this report, as of August 12, 2026, bounding the disclosed concentration by the portion that is withholdable rather than contractually protected]. That is severe without being existential while no alternative provider exists.

Litigation and governance

SpaceX accrued \$354 million for losses “probable and reasonably estimable” at June 30, 2026, gave no estimate for other matters, and warned that a loss “may be material or exceed its estimated ranges.”² The largest adjudicated item is small against this balance sheet: the European Commission’s Digital Services Act decision of December 5, 2025 fined the X entities,

x.AI and Musk EUR 120 million, under challenge in the EU General Court since February 16, 2026.² The July 16, 2026 dismissal of the music-publisher copyright case cut AI-segment legal expense by \$64 million in a single quarter, which marks the litigation cost sitting in run-rate operating expense. The Baltimore consumer-protection action of March 24, 2026 over Grok image generation names Space Exploration Technologies Corp. itself, so that exposure is not ring-fenced at the acquired subsidiary.²

Governance is a standing discount that has already cost one trading day. On June 22, 2026 MSCI assigned a CCC ESG rating, the bottom of its scale, on the same day the company announced a 144A notes offering; the stock fell 16.4%, its worst day since listing, and the rating remains a flow headwind through exclusion from sustainable-index mandates.¹²⁶¹⁹¹⁷ Sitting director Antonio Gracias disclosed 503.4 million Class A shares, 6.5% of the class, on August 4, 2026, and Valor-related entities are the counterparty to the equipment financings detailed in Section 5, while non-employee directors receive no compensation for reviewing such transactions.¹²⁷¹²⁸

Systemic and macro risk

If the company executes its plan perfectly, three macro conditions still break the thesis, and the filing quantifies none of them. Item 3 of the Q2 10-Q gives the effective interest rate on the notes as 6.03% at June 30, 2026 and states that no variable-rate debt was outstanding; no equity-price, commodity, power-price or digital-asset sensitivity appears anywhere in it, despite a bitcoin position carried at \$1,098 million and marked through earnings.²

Trade policy is the widest gap, on the disclosure Section 4 sets out. The only trade language in the Q2 10-Q says data-center spending may be cut and reallocated if demand ramps more slowly, “including due to global economic, tax, trade or business conditions,” for a business that sells consumer terminals and builds GPU-intensive data centers.² Reversible capex mitigates the exposure without sizing it.

Rates reach this equity through refinancing rather than debt service. First-time investment-grade ratings arrived in June 2026 at Moody’s Baa1, Fitch BBB+ and S&P BBB, all stable, with Moody’s constraining the rating on the AI buildout’s capital intensity and negative free cash flow.¹²⁹¹³⁰ Given the burn detailed in Section 5 and the 2027 commitments above, a return to the capital markets inside the forecast horizon is arithmetic, and the coupon on that issue is the exposure that matters. Easing cuts the other way: first-half interest income of \$553 million means a lower policy rate removes several hundred million dollars of annual pre-tax income.² Currency is immaterial at negative \$178 million of first-half translation adjustment.²

Roughly one-fifth of 2025 revenue came from U.S. federal agencies, so a continuing resolution or a budget rotation reprices that fifth with no operational failure.¹²⁵ India’s regulator rejected Starlink’s Gen-2 constellation application in January 2026, and the European Union is moving to cut its Starlink dependence with a sovereign alternative due in 2029.¹³¹¹³² Those are the markets subscriber growth would otherwise come from.

Sorting these by what they do to value: lock-up supply, the ESG rating and the litigation book add volatility. Customer terminability from December 31, 2026, an injunction against Colossus II power, a systematic constellation defect and the loss of the federal revenue base change terminal value. Solvency is not at issue through 2027, on the net cash position and the runway Section 5 computes, and not on management's July 15, 2031 maturity claim, which Section 5 qualifies from Note 9.²

Catalyst calendar

DATE	EVENT	WHY IT MATTERS	DIRECTION OF RISK
Aug 20 / Sep 9 / Sep 24 / Oct 9 / Oct 24, 2026 (scheduled)	7% lock-up tranches, roughly 300 million shares each ¹⁰⁹¹⁰⁸	Float grows with no index bid behind it	Negative supply
Late Aug 2026 (expected window)	NAACP preliminary-injunction hearing, N.D. Miss. ⁶²	Reaches compute capacity as well as damages	Sharpest one-day downside
Late Aug 2026 (expected)	Starship Flight 14, pending FAA approval [GUIDANCE, Q2 2026 call, August 4, 2026] ¹⁵¹³³	Validates V3 capacity or restarts a seven-week mishap clock gating V3, Starwind and Artemis	Two-sided
By Sep 30, 2026 (expected)	Cursor close, all-stock on a pre-close VWAP (Section 2) ²²¹	Dilution rises as the price falls	Two-sided
Nov 3, 2026 (scheduled)	Q3 2026 earnings; consensus EPS \$0.15 on revenue of \$13.13 billion [CONSENSUS, yfinance, as of August 12, 2026] ⁹⁵⁷⁶	Checkpoint on the December ARR target	Two-sided
Nov 5, 2026 (scheduled)	28% lock-up tranche, roughly 1.3 billion shares ¹⁰⁹	Largest 2026 supply event	Negative supply
Dec 8, 2026 (scheduled)	180-day residual, enlarged by the missed price trigger ¹⁰⁸¹⁷	Likely mis-anchored at the base-case tranche size	Negative supply
Dec 31, 2026 (scheduled)	Google's 90-day termination right begins ¹¹ ; management's \$100 billion December ARR checkpoint ¹⁵	Revenue turns cancelable against rigid 2027 commitments	Decisive downside
Early 2027 (expected)	Next FCC semiannual constellation report, against 207,152 maneuvers last period ¹⁰⁵	First read on whether congestion is compounding	Negative if it accelerates
Jun 12, 2027 (scheduled)	Musk block unlocks, roughly 6.4 billion shares on a lock-up tracker's estimate ¹⁰⁹	Largest supply event on the calendar	Negative supply
Jul 2027 (scheduled)	Mississippi agreed-order deadline to clear the last mobile turbines ¹¹⁶	Removes the permitting overhang if met	Positive if met

DATE	EVENT	WHY IT MATTERS	DIRECTION OF RISK
Nov 30, 2027 (modeled)	EchoStar spectrum closing: about 261.8 million shares at \$42.40 plus up to \$8.5 billion cash, \$827 million more if it slips a year ²	A dated call outside most 2026 models	Negative

What is priced and what is not

Priced in: lock-up supply generically, given the short base and the relief rally around August 6; capex intensity, given the 13.6% fall the day after the Q2 print and the August 5 target cuts detailed in Section 6.¹⁷⁸⁹ Underappreciated: a December 8 residual enlarged because the price trigger missed; December 31, 2026 as a contractual cliff; the turbine case as a compute-capacity risk; constellation failures that leave no charge in the accounts; and a favorable-treatment premium marked nowhere. Over-feared: Kessler risk at these altitudes, cancellation of federal contracts, and key-man loss as operational collapse. No firm downgraded the stock through the 48.7% drawdown from the June high to the July low,⁸⁹¹⁷ so the sell-side has repriced the multiple without questioning execution.



Exhibit 7 — The 10-year Treasury stands at 4.72% and the 2-year at 4.25% as of 2026-08-10, a +0.47pp spread; the 4.72% is the risk-free rate behind this report's 11-12% cost of capital and the level at which the next refinancing prices. Source: FRED (Federal Reserve Bank of St. Louis), 10-year window.

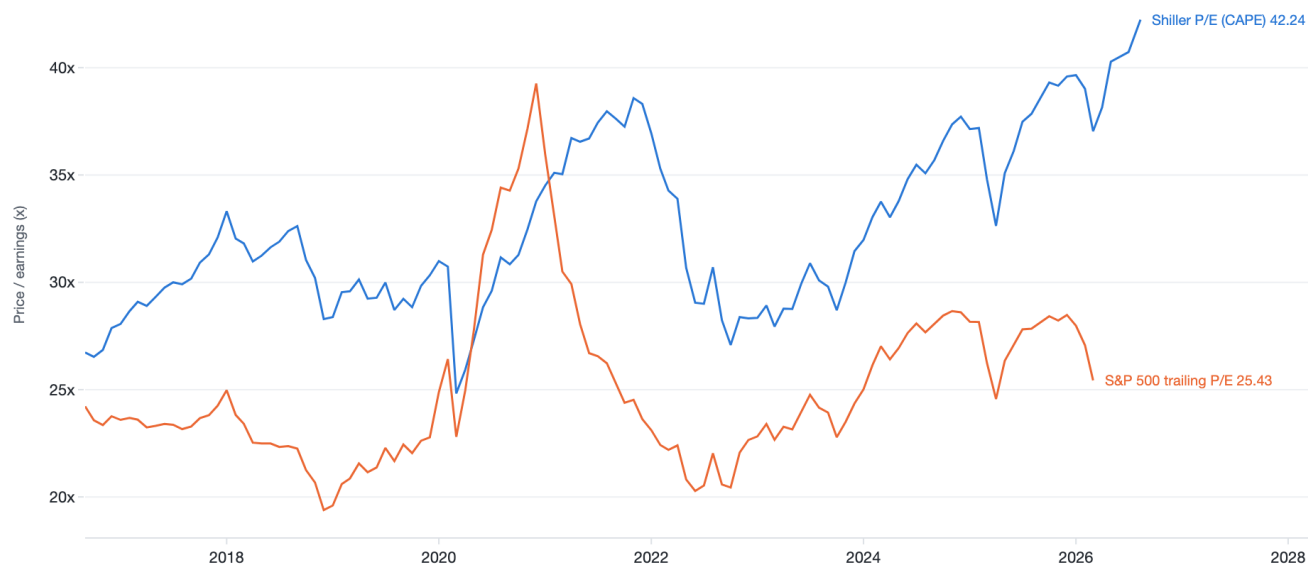


Exhibit 8 — The Shiller P/E is 42.2x as of 2026-08-11, the market-level multiple against which a de-rating thesis has to be read. The S&P 500 trailing P/E of 25.4x on the same chart was last read on 2026-03-01 and lags the CAPE line by five months. Source: multpl.com, 10-year window.

Conclusion: Investment Thesis

We rate SpaceX a Sell with a 12-month fair value of \$38.13 per share, 71.4% below the August 11, 2026 close of \$133.29 [ESTIMATE, this report, as of August 12, 2026].²¹⁷ The figure comes from Section 6's ten-year discounted cash flow at a 12% weighted average cost of capital, with 88% of enterprise value in terminal value because explicit-period free cash flow stays negative until 2030. Morningstar values launch and Starlink alone at roughly \$40 per share, within \$2 of our base.⁷⁷ Section 6 also carries a probability-weighted scenario value of \$125.94, which on its own would imply Hold, and we do not average the two. They differ on whether the capital that builds the business is charged against the value of it. Our cash-flow model charges it; the scenario model capitalizes an adjusted EBITDA measure management defines to exclude all depreciation, share-based compensation and restructuring.² The cash-flow figure governs the rating.

Conviction is medium, and three things hold it there. SpaceX has 41 trading days of price history and has never filed a 10-K, so the discount rate rests on a 3.83 regression beta that 41 observations cannot make stable.¹⁷ Consensus sits far above us: the median sell-side target is \$210.00 and the mean \$235.69, ratings run 80% positive, and no firm downgraded through the 48.7% drawdown from the June high to the July low.⁸⁹⁸⁸¹⁷ We differ from that panel on the multiple rather than on the operating forecast, because our base scenario's revenue path lands on the fiscal 2027 consensus of \$95.49 billion (Yahoo Finance, 17 analysts, as of August 12, 2026).⁷⁶ The bull case carries 20% probability against 50% on the base and 30% on the bear, and it is not remote: 2028 revenue near \$260 billion at a 55% adjusted EBITDA margin gives \$271.20 per share.

A buyer at \$133.29 is underwriting terminal value on revenue a counterparty can withdraw a quarter at a time. Spot requires 2035 revenue near \$2.35 trillion, or a 66% terminal EBIT margin, or a 6.63% cost of capital, the last below the 5.855% weighted-average coupon SpaceX itself paid on the June 2026 notes.¹⁵ What the buyer gets in exchange is Connectivity's 38.6% second-quarter segment operating margin on 12.0 million subscribers, the only segment operating profit in the company, set against consolidated return on invested capital of negative 6.3% annualized and first-half free cash flow of negative \$25.0 billion.²⁶⁹ For the base case to hold, Google's \$920 million a month and Anthropic's \$1.25 billion a month must run past their 90-day termination windows, Connectivity must hold margin while ARPU stays at \$66, and capex must stay fundable out of \$100.0 billion of cash and securities at a burn near \$15.7 billion a quarter.¹¹²²² Section 4's \$28.0 billion of non-cancelable commitments, \$22.2 billion of it due in 2027, does not flex when any of those fail.²

Key Tests

TEST	WHAT MUST BE TRUE	WHAT WE WOULD SEE IF WRONG	TIMEFRAME
Anchor cloud contracts run to term	Google's \$920 million a month survives the termination right that opens after December 31, 2026, and Anthropic's \$1.25 billion a month is not repriced ¹¹	AI segment revenue below the \$2,561 million of Q2 2026, or a disclosed GPU-count reduction or fee cut ²	Q4 2026 and Q1 2027 results
Connectivity funds the build	Segment operating margin holds at or above the 37.7% first-half level with ARPU no lower than \$66 a month ²	Margin under 37.7% with ARPU under \$66, turning the one self-funding segment into a user of capital	Q3 2026 (November 3) and Q4 2026
Server asset lives are not shortened	Servers and networking equipment of \$34.8 billion keep a life near the 6.0-year composite implied by first-half depreciation ²	The first 10-K moves toward a three-year life, adding roughly \$5.8 billion of annual depreciation	FY2026 10-K, Q1 2027
AI capital converts to profit	The AI segment's \$(1,257) million quarterly operating loss narrows as \$15.8 billion a quarter of AI capex leases up ²	A segment loss wider than \$(1,257) million in any quarter while capex runs at that rate	Every print through Q4 2027

Monitoring Dashboard

INDICATOR	CURRENT	THRESHOLD	CHECK	IMPLICATION IF BREACHED
AI segment revenue	\$2,561 million, Q2 2026 ²	Below \$2,400 million in any quarter	Quarterly	Anchor repricing is under way; the bear case near \$40 becomes the base, roughly 70% below spot
Starlink ARPU	\$66 a month, Q2 2026, flat against Q1 2026 ²	Below \$60 with net adds under 1.4 million in a quarter	Quarterly	Connectivity stops outgrowing its price decline; we cut the 48% base-case 2028 margin
Cash and marketable securities	\$100.0 billion at June 30, 2026 ²	Below \$60 billion with no raise announced	Quarterly	Under two years of runway at the current burn; dilution risk moves from possible to scheduled
Quarterly capital expenditure	\$18,369 million, Q2 2026, guided flat for two quarters ²¹⁵	Above \$18.4 billion for two more quarters with the AI loss not narrowing	Quarterly	Confirms the ROIC path; fair value falls toward the \$23.76 of the 15% discount-rate case
Consolidated operating income	\$(143) million in Q2 2026 ²	Two consecutive positive quarters	Quarterly	Explicit-period cash flow turns earlier; we would revisit toward the scenario frame and a Hold

INDICATOR	CURRENT	THRESHOLD	CHECK	IMPLICATION IF BREACHED
Lock-up supply against short interest	219.3 million shares short, about 34% of float, week of August 3, 2026 ⁷⁹	The 28% tranche on November 5, 2026 clears without a squeeze	Event-driven	Positioning support goes; this moves the entry point rather than fair value

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Data sources

SOURCE	USED FOR
SEC EDGAR (10-K, 10-Q, 8-K)	Authoritative reported figures, risk factors, MD&A, legal proceedings, market-risk disclosures
yfinance	Financial statements, ratios, peer metrics, consensus estimates and revisions, price targets, event calendar
Financial Modeling Prep	Peer identification, institutional holders, supplementary market data
FRED and multpl	Macro rates, inflation, and market-level valuation series
TA-Lib	Technical indicators
Web and MCP research tools	Competitive, supply-chain and news context, each harvested to its origin document

SOURCE	USED FOR
Wikipedia	Background and corporate history

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Where two sources disagree on a figure, the SEC filing value is used and the discrepancy is noted. A value a provider did not report is shown as absent, never as zero.

Glossary

CAGR compound annual growth rate · **DCF** discounted cash flow · **EV/EBITDA** enterprise value to earnings before interest, tax, depreciation and amortisation · **FCF** free cash flow, operating cash flow less capital expenditure · **NOPAT** net operating profit after tax · **P/E** price to earnings · **ROIC** return on invested capital, NOPAT divided by invested capital · **SBC** stock-based compensation · **SOTP** sum of the parts · **TAM / SAM** total / serviceable addressable market · **TTM** trailing twelve months · **WACC** weighted average cost of capital · **bp** basis point, one hundredth of a percentage point.

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This report is for informational purposes only and does not constitute investment advice. Conduct your own due diligence and consult financial professionals before making investment decisions. Past performance does not guarantee future results.